

UNIVERSITY OF PADOVA - ICT FOR INTERNET AND MULTIMEDIA

Project Management

3 CFU – 24 Hours

5 MODULES – FROM IDEA TO REAL IMPACT

14 LESSONS

2026/2027

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ENGLISH VERSION

NOTES — SLIDE 1

COURSE AND LESSON ORIENTATION

This course examines how projects turn ideas and strategy into coordinated action and measurable value. Lesson 1 establishes the vocabulary used throughout the course: project, operations, program, portfolio, project manager, organizational authority, PMO, output, outcome, benefit, and value.

Study this lesson as a connected system rather than a list of definitions. First classify the work. Then identify the intended change and value. Finally examine who has authority, how decisions are governed, and what evidence demonstrates success.

STUDY TIP: For each concept, prepare a definition, one example, one non-example, and the decision it helps a manager make.

REVIEW QUESTION: Can a project meet its deadline and budget yet fail to create value? Explain why.

Course Map

MOODLE: SELF-ENROLMENT KEY : PM2026



#	DATE	TOPIC	#	DATE	TOPIC
01	30 Sep	Project Fundamentals	08	18 Nov	Earned Value Management & KPIs
02	07 Oct	Project Methodological approaches: Waterfall, Agile and Hybrid	09	25 Nov	Risk & Issue Management
03	14 Oct	Project Charter, Assumptions & Constraints	10	02 Dec	Integrated Change & Adoption
04	21 Oct	Stakeholder Analysis & Engagement	11	09 Dec	Team Building & Leadership
05	28 Oct	Agile, Scrum, Kanban & Events	12	16 Dec	PM Tools: Group Presentation
06	04 Nov	Work Breakdown Structure & Scope management	13	23 Dec	PM Tools: Group Presentation
07	11 Nov	Integrated Project Planning & Critical Path	14	13 Jan	PM with AI and Key Concept – Exam Prep.

NOTES — SLIDE 2

COURSE MAP

Use this map to understand the learning sequence rather than treating each session as an isolated topic. The course begins with project fundamentals, then develops methods, planning, stakeholder engagement, risk, delivery, control, leadership, and final integration. Each later topic depends on earlier distinctions: for example, risk responses depend on clear objectives, while change control depends on a reliable baseline.

When studying, connect every session to three questions: What decision does this topic support? What evidence is required? Who owns the decision? Create a one-page learning log and add one tool, one example, and one unresolved question after each lesson. This turns the course map into a revision plan and reveals connections across modules.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which three sessions appear most strongly connected, and what management decision links them?

01

PART 01 • LESSON IN CLASS

LESSON: PROJECT FUNDAMENTALS

Projects turn strategy into measurable value.

Project Thinking: From Outputs to Value

≈ 2 HOURS

In-class session time

WHAT YOU EXPLORE

Concepts • Example • Classroom practice

HOW YOU CHECK

Live quiz • Peer review • Self-check

003

NOTES — SLIDE 3

IN-CLASS SESSION — HOW THIS LESSON RUNS

This divider opens Part 01, the 120-minute classroom lesson on project fundamentals. The lesson moves from concepts to an example, then to classroom practice: definitions and the project/operations boundary, the shift from constraints to value, project-program-portfolio, the project manager's role and authority, and finally the Vision Board workshop.

Announce the three checkpoints up front so students know how they will be tested: the live quiz on project/program/portfolio, the peer review of the Vision Boards, and the self-check at the end of the session.

By the end of the session every team should be able to build and defend a Vision Board. Part 02, the self-study section, starts after the closing slide.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of today's three checkpoints will tell you most reliably whether you understood the lesson?

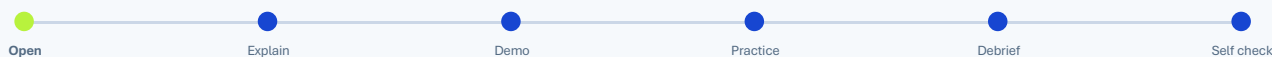
What students will be able to do

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Define a project and operations
- Connect outputs, outcomes, benefits, and strategic value
- Build a visual board that organizes a project idea
- Compare project, program and portfolio management

120-MINUTE RUN OF SHOW

- 0–15 **Opening case**
- 15–40 Project, Program, Portfolio
- 40–65 The Project Manager role
- 65–75 Break
- 75–110 **Visual-board workshop**
- 110–120 Debrief



NOTES — SLIDE 4

LEARNING OUTCOMES

The lesson is designed around application, not memorization alone. By the end, you should be able to classify work as a project, program, portfolio, or operation; connect outputs to outcomes, benefits, and value; explain how governance and organizational structure affect authority; and use visual tools to align a team around a product or service idea.

Study each outcome as a performance task. “Define” requires accurate vocabulary. “Connect” requires a causal explanation supported by evidence. “Compare” requires criteria and trade-offs, not a list of features. “Build” requires a usable artifact that helps a team make a decision. The run of show moves from concepts to examples, practice, and retrieval so that understanding is tested in several ways.

STUDY TIP: After each section, explain the concept aloud without looking at the slide and then apply it to one familiar initiative.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which outcome would be hardest to demonstrate, and what evidence would prove competence?

01

FOUNDATIONS & VALUE

Project Definition

What a project is — and what it is not.

LESSON 01 • PMI; ISO 21502

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 5

FOUNDATIONS AND VALUE

Projects are not valuable merely because they produce activity or deliverables. They convert strategic intent into a defined change, and their success depends on whether that change is useful and sustainable. This lesson therefore begins by separating temporary project work from ongoing operations and by making the path from output to value visible.

Use the guiding question to test any initiative. Ask whether the work has a defined end, creates something sufficiently unique, changes a current condition, and contains uncertainty that requires coordinated decisions. Then ask why the initiative deserves resources compared with other possibilities. A strong answer identifies the intended outcome, the stakeholders affected, and the evidence that would demonstrate value.

EXAMPLE: Building a new student portal is a project; operating and supporting it after launch is ongoing service work.

REVIEW QUESTION: What evidence would make a proposed university initiative worth funding?



LESSON 01 • QUESTION

“What is a project for you?”

LESSON 01 • CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

006

NOTES — SLIDE 6

OPENING DISCUSSION: "WHAT IS A PROJECT FOR YOU?"

Open the lesson with the question and collect four or five answers without correcting any of them. Write the key words on the board: most students will name a deadline, a team, a goal, or an assignment. Keep the list visible — the formal definition on the next slides will be tested against it.

The point of the activity is to surface the everyday meaning of the word before replacing it with a management definition. Watch for two common patterns: treating any large or difficult task as a project, and treating any teamwork as a project. Both ignore the decisive criteria, which are a defined end and a unique result.

STUDY TIP: Write your own one-sentence definition now, then revise it after the PMI definition and note exactly what changed.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which word in your spontaneous definition survives the formal definition, and which one has to go?

Project definition

01 ACADEMIC VIEW

“A project is a sequence of unique, complex, and connected activities that have one goal or purpose and that must be completed by a specific time, within budget, and according to specification.”

R. K. Wysocki, Effective Project Management, 8th ed., Wiley, 2019

02 PROFESSIONAL STANDARD — PMI, 8TH EDITION

“A temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context, with the objective of generating value.”

PMI, PMBOK® Guide – The Standard for Project Management, 8th ed.

● TEMPORARY

A defined beginning and end — not necessarily short.

● ENDEAVOR

Coordinated work, decisions, resources, and learning.

● UNIQUE

The result or context differs from routine operations.

■ TEACHING DISTINCTION

Projects create change; operations sustain repeatable value after transition.

NOTES — SLIDE 7

PMI CORE DEFINITION

PMI (PMBOK® Guide, 8th ed.) defines a project as a temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context, with the objective of generating value. Each word matters.

TEMPORARY refers to the endeavor, not necessarily to its output. A building, information system, policy, or service may continue for years after the project closes. The project ends when its objectives have been achieved, the work is terminated, or responsibility is transferred. Temporary also does not mean short: a multi-year infrastructure initiative remains temporary.

ENDEAVOR emphasizes coordinated effort. Projects combine decisions, people, resources, learning, risk responses, and stakeholder engagement. They are not merely task lists.

UNIQUE refers to the context: the result, stakeholders, constraints or technology differ from routine operations, even when repeatable methods are used. The 8th edition makes value, not the deliverable alone, the stated objective of the endeavor.

The practical boundary is transition: project work creates or changes capability; operations sustain, use, and improve that capability after handover.

STUDY TIP: Test any initiative word by word — is it temporary, is it coordinated, is the result unique?

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of the three words is most often ignored in everyday use of the word "project", and what mistakes does that cause?

FEEDBACK EXERCISE: Project Examples

FEEDBACK COLLECTION : LET'S IDENTIFY A PROJECT!



Building a new house;



Processing customer orders



Improving an organizational business process



Writing a book



Developing a new software application;



Performing recommended equipment maintenance procedures

EXAMPLES:

- Merging two organizations.
- Relocating a company's technology infrastructure to a new location or to a cloud platform

STUDY PROMPT

Which of these examples is a project?

NOTES — SLIDE 8

IDENTIFYING PROJECT WORK

Classify each example by asking whether it is a temporary endeavor that creates a unique result or change. Building a house, developing a new application, writing a book, improving a business process, merging organizations, and relocating infrastructure can be projects when they have defined objectives and completion criteria.

Processing customer orders and performing routine maintenance are normally operations because they repeat to sustain an existing service. However, redesigning the order process or introducing a new maintenance system could be projects. Context and management purpose determine the classification.

STUDY TIP: Replace “Is this activity large?” with “Is this temporary change or recurring work?”

REVIEW QUESTION: How could a routine operational activity become the subject of a project?

Projects change; operations sustain

The work is connected—but its purpose, rhythm, and success evidence differ.

01 PROJECT

PURPOSE	Create a defined change, capability, or unique result.
TIME HORIZON	Temporary: a defined beginning and end.
WORK PATTERN	Evolving work shaped by assumptions, learning, and uncertainty.
SUCCESS EVIDENCE	Accepted outputs, enabled outcomes, and transition readiness.
PRIMARY OWNERSHIP	Sponsor and project leadership drive the temporary endeavor.

02 SERVICE OPERATIONS

PURPOSE	Deliver and sustain an ongoing service or repeatable value.
TIME HORIZON	Continuous: no planned end while the service remains needed.
WORK PATTERN	Repeatable work stabilized through processes, standards, and routines.
SUCCESS EVIDENCE	Reliable service, user experience, quality, and operational performance.
PRIMARY OWNERSHIP	Service owner and operational teams sustain performance after handover.

The transition is successful when operations can sustain the value without the project team.

NOTES — SLIDE 9

PROJECTS AND SERVICE OPERATIONS

Projects and operations are connected but have different purposes. A project creates a defined change or unique capability within a temporary boundary. Operations sustain products and services through repeatable processes, service levels, and continuous ownership. The distinction affects funding, governance, roles, success measures, and the meaning of completion.

Do not classify work only by the type of task. The same people and technology may participate in both. Instead, examine the purpose and time horizon. Designing and launching a help-desk platform is temporary project work; operating the help desk, resolving tickets, and improving service performance are operations. A project is not complete simply because an output is accepted: transition readiness matters, including training, support, data, documentation, capacity, and ownership.

STUDY TIP: Draw a boundary around the temporary change and list what must pass to operations.

REVIEW QUESTION: What would demonstrate that operations can sustain value without the project team?

What makes an initiative a project?

- | | | |
|----|---------------|---|
| 01 | TEMPORARY | It has a defined beginning and end, even when the product or benefit continues. |
| 02 | UNIQUE RESULT | It creates a product, service, capability, or outcome that is not routine repetition. |
| 03 | CHANGE | It moves stakeholders from a current state toward a desired future state. |
| 04 | UNCERTAINTY | Objectives are pursued with incomplete information, assumptions, constraints, and risk. |

NOTES — SLIDE 10

WHAT MAKES AN INITIATIVE A PROJECT?

Four characteristics help identify project work. It is temporary, meaning that the coordinated endeavor has a defined beginning and end even if the resulting product continues. It creates a unique result or context rather than repeating an established routine. It enables change from a current state toward a desired future state. It also contains uncertainty: objectives must be pursued with assumptions, constraints, incomplete information, and risk.

These characteristics are diagnostic rather than independent checkboxes. A recurring event may still contain a project when a new format, venue, or capability is designed and launched. Conversely, a complex activity is not automatically a project if it is continuous and repeatable. Classification matters because temporary change requires explicit authorization, integration, acceptance, transition, and closure.

EXAMPLE: Introducing a new digital-exam process is a project; scheduling and administering exams each semester is operational work.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which characteristic is most useful when an initiative seems partly project and partly operation?

LESSON 01 • QUESTION

“How many of you, in your courses, have already encountered the famous Iron Triangle? Time, Cost, Scope. Raise hands high.”

NOTES — SLIDE 11

ACTIVATING PRIOR KNOWLEDGE: THE IRON TRIANGLE

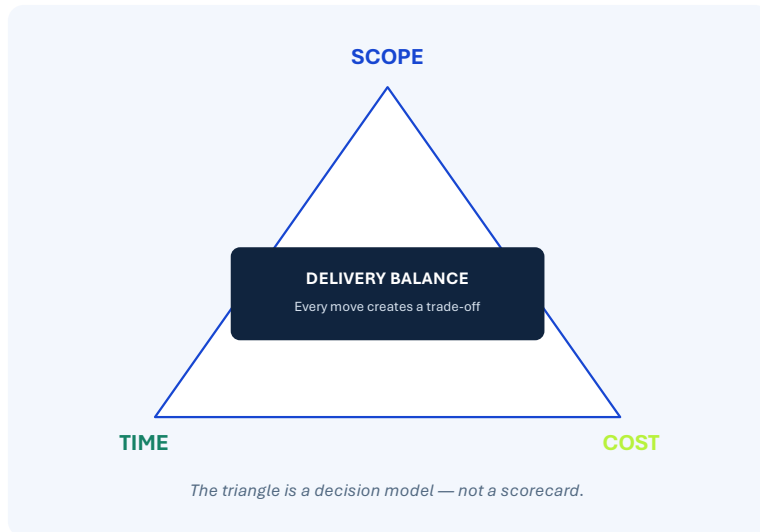
The iron triangle represents three classic project constraints: scope, time, and cost. Scope describes what must be delivered, time describes when it must be completed, and cost describes the resources or budget available. The model helps make trade-offs visible because a change in one constraint usually affects one or both of the others.

This question is a diagnostic prompt. Recall where you encountered the model and what assumptions it made about success. The next slides show why constraint performance is necessary but insufficient when quality, adoption, outcomes, benefits, and stakeholder value are considered.

STUDY TIP: Prepare one example of a trade-off among scope, time, and cost.

REVIEW QUESTION: Why does meeting all three constraints not automatically prove project success?

The iron triangle



CLASSIC CONSTRAINTS

Scope, time, and cost trade off against one another.

CORE DYNAMIC

Change one side and the other two must respond.

NOTES — SLIDE 12

THE CLASSIC IRON TRIANGLE

The iron triangle is a decision model for understanding interactions among scope, time, and cost. Increasing scope may require more time or money. Compressing the schedule may increase cost, reduce feasible scope, or increase risk. Reducing the budget may require a narrower solution, a longer schedule, or a different delivery approach.

The triangle does not prescribe which constraint must remain fixed. Sponsors and stakeholders should identify priorities, tolerances, and decision rights. Quality should not be treated as an invisible variable that can be sacrificed without an explicit decision.

STUDY TIP: When a constraint changes, state the impact, available options, assumptions, and required decision.

REVIEW QUESTION: If the deadline cannot move, which alternatives should be evaluated before reducing quality?

Paradox of modern management

“

The Iron Triangle measures **efficiency**, but it completely ignores **value**. You cannot afford to just be **efficient**. You need to be **impactful**.

EFFICIENCY ≠ VALUE

Delivery discipline matters only when the result creates impact.



NOTES — SLIDE 13

EFFICIENCY IS NOT VALUE

The iron triangle measures delivery efficiency: whether agreed scope was produced within time and cost constraints. This information is necessary, but it cannot show whether the project solved the right problem or produced a useful change. A perfectly controlled project may still create an output that nobody adopts.

Value requires evidence beyond completion: quality, user acceptance, outcome change, realized benefits, and strategic relevance. The project manager therefore protects delivery discipline while continuously checking whether the work still deserves investment.

STUDY TIP: Use two scorecards—one for delivery performance and one for outcome and benefit evidence.

REVIEW QUESTION: Give an example of a project that could be efficient but unsuccessful.

“So, if we break the Iron Triangle, what replaces it? How do we define success in the modern era?”

From delivering on constraints to delivering value.

NOTES — SLIDE 14

BRIDGE: WHAT REPLACES THE IRON TRIANGLE?

This is a transition question, not a content slide. Pause here and let students propose their own answer before the next slides introduce quality, stakeholder satisfaction, adoption, outcomes and benefits.

The point to establish: scope, time and cost remain necessary as delivery commitments, but they describe efficiency, not success. A modern success definition adds fitness for purpose, acceptance, adoption and realized benefit — each with a measure and an owner.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which measure would you add first to a project you know, and who would own it?

Project success goes beyond the iron triangle

"If your project plan is so locked into an 'Iron' triangle that you cannot adapt when the market changes, you aren't managing a project—you are just documenting its obsolescence. The traditional triangle assumes that the world stops spinning while you are executing your project. But we all know the world doesn't stop."

So, if we break the Iron Triangle, what replaces it? How do we define success in the modern era?



CLASSIC CONSTRAINTS

Scope, time, and cost trade off against one another.

MODERN SUCCESS

Quality

Does the result work as intended?

Satisfaction

Do stakeholders recognize and accept the value?

NOTES — SLIDE 15

SUCCESS BEYOND THE IRON TRIANGLE

Scope, time, and cost describe delivery commitments, but they do not fully define success. Quality asks whether the output is fit for purpose and meets requirements and acceptance criteria. Satisfaction reflects whether relevant stakeholders understand, accept, adopt, and value the result.

A project can finish on time and within budget yet fail because the solution is unreliable, unusable, rejected, or disconnected from the intended outcome. Conversely, a justified change to a constraint can protect greater value when it is governed transparently and supported by evidence.

STUDY TIP: Use separate measures for delivery efficiency, output quality, stakeholder adoption, outcomes, and benefits.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which evidence would demonstrate success after the deliverable has been accepted?

Be the Architects of Value

We shift our focus from Outputs to Outcomes. To move beyond the triangle, you must master three new pillars:

THREE PRINCIPLES

1 Value over volume

Instead of asking 'How much did we build?', the modern project leader asks 'What value did we unlock?'. Value can be financial ROI, it can be social impact, or it can be sustainability. If a project goes 10% over budget but generates 300% more value than expected, it is a massive success.

2 User Adoption and Experience

A product is only successful if it is used. Traditional project management stops at the handover—the moment the project is delivered to the client. Modern project management extends into the lifecycle. Did the users adopt it? Did it solve their actual frustration?

3 Organizational Agility

The scope shouldn't be cast in iron; it should be fluid. The best project managers are those who have the courage to say: 'The data shows our original scope is no longer relevant. We need to pivot.' Adapting to change is a sign of leadership, not a sign of failure.

TRANSFER TO PRACTICE

“How does this feature align with our long-term vision?”

ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

By looking beyond the Iron Triangle, you elevate yourself from a technical executor to a strategic leader. You stop being the person who just drives the car, and you become the person who helps navigate the map.

NOTES — SLIDE 16

ARCHITECTS OF VALUE

Moving beyond the iron triangle does not mean ignoring constraints. It means treating scope, time, and cost as boundaries within a broader success model. Project leaders connect outputs to outcomes, benefits, user adoption, organizational capability, and strategic value.

Three principles guide practice. First, evaluate value rather than volume of activity or features. Second, gather evidence of user adoption and experience rather than stopping at handover. Third, adapt deliberately when data shows that assumptions, priorities, or the original scope are no longer valid.

APPLICATION: Ask how a proposed feature supports the intended outcome, how adoption will be measured, who owns the benefit, and when the evidence will be reviewed.

REVIEW QUESTION: How does a project manager remain accountable while adapting the plan?

Success extends beyond scope, time, and cost

THREE PRINCIPLES

- 1** Delivery efficiency matters, but it does not prove that the right outcome was created.
- 2** Quality and acceptance connect completed outputs to stakeholder use.
- 3** Benefits and strategic value may emerge after the project team has closed.

TRANSFER TO PRACTICE

- Define success measures before detailed planning.
- Track adoption and outcomes as well as deliverables.
- Assign benefit ownership beyond project closure.

ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

A successful project balances delivery constraints while enabling valuable, sustainable change.

NOTES — SLIDE 17

SUCCESS BEYOND THE IRON TRIANGLE

Scope, time, and cost remain important because they describe delivery commitments and constraints. However, meeting them does not prove that the project created the right outcome. Modern success also includes quality, stakeholder acceptance, adoption, benefits, strategic alignment, and the ability of operations to sustain the change.

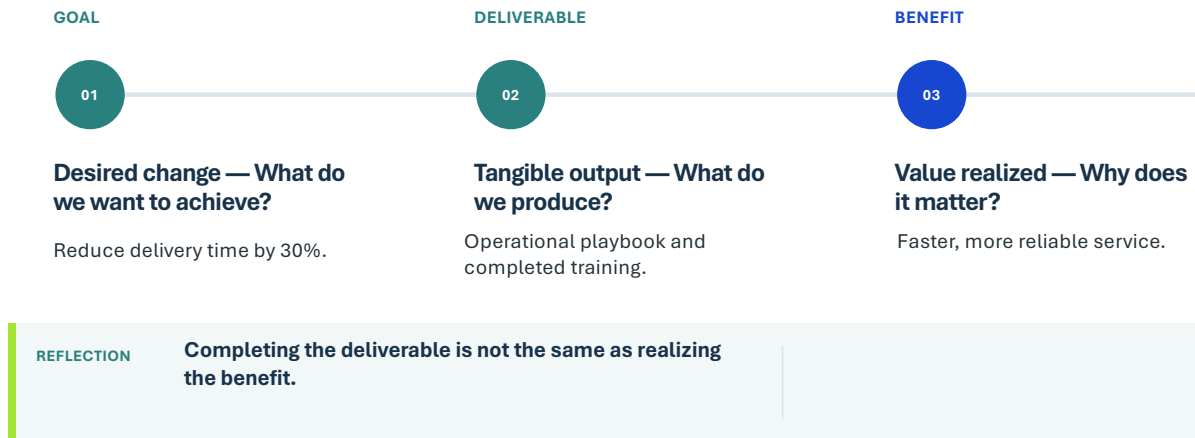
The three principles on this slide form a sequence. Efficient delivery creates an output. Quality and acceptance make the output usable. Adoption and changed behavior enable benefits, which may emerge after the temporary project has closed. This means success measures must be defined early and distributed across time. Some indicators belong to the project team, while others require a sponsor, product owner, service owner, or benefit owner after handover.

STUDY TIP: For a familiar project, write one measure for delivery, one for adoption, one for outcome, and one for long-term benefit.

REVIEW QUESTION: Can a project be operationally late yet strategically successful? State the assumptions behind your answer.

Goals, deliverables, and benefits define success

Projects produce outputs—but success depends on the change and value those outputs enable.



NOTES — SLIDE 18

GOALS, DELIVERABLES, AND BENEFITS

A goal expresses the intended direction or change. A deliverable is a verifiable product, result, or capability produced by the project. A benefit is a measurable gain or advantage that stakeholders value. These concepts are connected but not interchangeable.

For example, a university may aim to improve student access to services. The deliverable could be a new digital portal. The expected outcome could be faster and more consistent service use. The benefit could be reduced waiting time, improved satisfaction, or lower administrative effort. Delivering the portal does not prove that the goal or benefit has been achieved.

The handover boundary matters because benefits often emerge after the project has delivered and operations begin using the result. The project team should therefore clarify operational readiness, benefit ownership, measures, baselines, review dates, and assumptions before closure.

STUDY TIP: Identify where responsibility moves from creating the capability to sustaining it.

REVIEW QUESTION: Who remains accountable for measuring the intended benefit once the project team has closed?

The project lifecycle structures decisions over time



TEACHING NOTE Lifecycle phases organize governance and decision points; the delivery approach inside them may be waterfall predictive or adaptive (Lesson 2).

NOTES — SLIDE 19

THE PROJECT LIFECYCLE

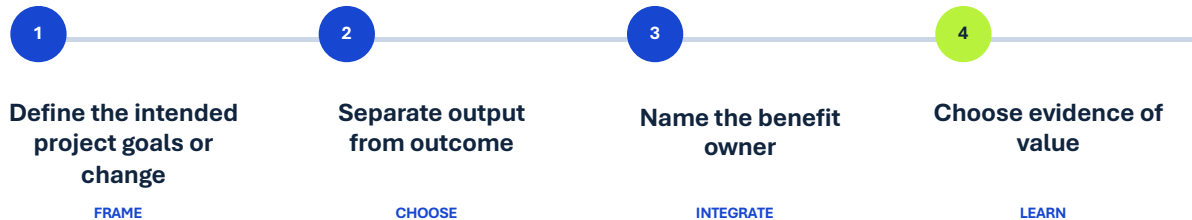
A lifecycle structures management decisions over time. Initiation tests whether the work is justified and authorizes responsibility. Planning defines how objectives, resources, risks, quality, stakeholders, and governance will be managed. Execution integrates people and work to create outputs. Monitoring and control compare evidence with expectations, support forecasting, and trigger decisions or adaptation. Closure confirms acceptance, transition, learning, and release of resources.

The phases are decision structures, not rigid departments or a guarantee of sequential work. Activities may overlap, and delivery may be organized in different ways. What matters is that the organization knows when key decisions are made, what evidence is required, and who has authority. A lifecycle should prevent investment from continuing automatically when assumptions or value have weakened.

STUDY TIP: For each phase, write one decision, one required evidence item, and one accountable role.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information should be available before a project moves from initiation into detailed planning?

Value chain: a four-step working method



OUTPUT A usable value chain with owners, evidence, assumptions, and review points.

NOTES — SLIDE 20

THE VALUE-CHAIN METHOD

The value chain converts a vague project idea into a testable logic for delivery and benefits.

1. **DEFINE THE INTENDED CHANGE.** Describe the current condition, desired future condition, affected population, and why the change matters. Avoid starting with the preferred solution.
2. **SEPARATE OUTPUT FROM OUTCOME.** State what the project will deliver and what people or systems should do differently after using it.
3. **NAME THE BENEFIT OWNER.** This is the role accountable for sustaining the outcome and monitoring benefits after handover. The owner may be different from the project manager.
4. **CHOOSE EVIDENCE OF VALUE.** Identify indicators, baselines, targets, data sources, review dates, and decision thresholds.

A strong value chain also records assumptions and review points. For example, "if students receive timely reminders, attendance will increase" is an assumption that should be tested. The value chain is not a guarantee; it is a transparent hypothesis linking investment, delivery, adoption, and value.

STUDY TIP: Write each link as "if... then..." and ask what evidence would disprove it.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of the four steps is most often skipped in practice, and what goes wrong when it is?

From deliverable to value

01	OUTPUT	A tangible or intangible product, service, or result produced by the project and accepted against defined criteria. Example: a redesigned online enrolment portal.
02	OUTCOME	A change in behavior, capability, or condition enabled when stakeholders use the output in practice. Example: students submit applications with fewer errors.
03	BENEFIT	A measurable improvement arising from outcomes; it needs an owner, baseline, target, and review period. Example: fewer corrections and faster application processing.
04	VALUE	The net importance of benefits when weighed against cost, risk, timing, opportunity cost, and strategic fit. Example: the improvement justifies implementation cost and risk.

NOTES — SLIDE 21

FROM DELIVERABLE TO VALUE

The four levels describe a causal chain. An output is the accepted product, service, or result created by project work. An outcome is the change in behavior, capability, or condition that occurs when stakeholders use the output. A benefit is a measurable improvement arising from that outcome. Value is the importance of those benefits after considering cost, risk, timing, opportunity cost, and strategic fit.

Follow the enrolment-portal example carefully. The portal itself is the output. Fewer submission errors represent an outcome because user behavior and performance have changed. Fewer corrections and faster processing are measurable benefits. The initiative creates value only if those benefits justify implementation and operating costs and remain aligned with university priorities. Each arrow contains assumptions, so measurement and ownership are essential.

STUDY TIP: Avoid using these terms as synonyms. Write them as “If output, then outcome; if outcome, then benefit,” and test the logic.

REVIEW QUESTION: What evidence would challenge the assumed link between the new portal and faster processing?

01

PROJECT • PROGRAM • PORTFOLIO

Projects, Programs and Portfolios

Navigating the Hierarchy of Success.

What is the difference?

LESSON 01 • PMI; ISO 21502

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 22

PROJECTS, PROGRAMS, AND PORTFOLIOS

This section changes the management lens from one temporary endeavor to coordinated benefits and strategic investment. A project focuses on creating a unique result and enabling a specific change. A program coordinates related projects and activities because their combined benefits cannot be achieved as effectively when managed separately. A portfolio groups projects, programs, and sometimes operations to execute strategy, balance risk, allocate capacity, and prioritize funding.

The categories are not levels of importance or size. A small program may coordinate several tightly connected components, while a very large project can still be one project if it creates one integrated result. The correct classification depends on the management objective: result, benefits, or strategy. Classification affects governance, measures, leadership roles, and the questions decision makers ask.

STUDY TIP: When uncertain, ask what must be managed together and why.

REVIEW QUESTION: What would justify managing several university digital initiatives as a program rather than as independent projects?

Project, program, and portfolio address different management objectives

01

PROJECT

A temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context, with the objective of generating value.

Projects ask “How will we deliver this result?”

PRIMARY AIM

Create the intended result and enable value.

MANAGED THROUGH

Scope, schedule, cost, quality, risk, resources, and stakeholder engagement.

02

PROGRAM

Related projects, subsidiary programs, and program activities managed in a coordinated manner to obtain benefits not available from managing them individually.

Programs ask “How will coordinated components realize benefits?”

PRIMARY AIM

Realize benefits by coordinating related components and dependencies.

MANAGED THROUGH

Benefits, integration, governance, interdependencies, and organizational change.

03

PORTFOLIO

Projects, programs, subsidiary portfolios, and operations managed as a group to achieve strategic objectives.

Portfolios ask “Which investments best execute strategy?”

PRIMARY AIM

Select and balance investments to execute strategy.

MANAGED THROUGH

Prioritization, authorization, risk balance, capacity, funding, and performance oversight.

NOTES — SLIDE 23

PROJECT, PROGRAM, AND PORTFOLIO

A **PROJECT** is a temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context to generate value. Its management integrates delivery variables such as scope, schedule, cost, quality, resources, risk, and stakeholder engagement to create the intended result and enable value.

A **PROGRAM** coordinates related projects, subsidiary programs, and program activities to obtain benefits that would not be available if the components were managed independently. Program management focuses on dependencies, shared capabilities, governance, organizational change, and benefit realization. Components may have different schedules and outputs but contribute to a common outcome.

A **PORTFOLIO** groups projects, programs, subsidiary portfolios, and operations to achieve strategic objectives. Portfolio components do not need to be directly related. Portfolio management selects, prioritizes, authorizes, balances, and reviews investments according to strategy, risk, capacity, funding, and performance.

Use the level of management that matches the decision. Projects ask “How will we deliver this result?” Programs ask “How will coordinated components realize benefits?” Portfolios ask “Which investments best execute strategy?”

STUDY TIP: The categories are not sizes. Ask what must be managed together, and why.

REVIEW QUESTION: What evidence would justify promoting a set of independent projects into a program?

A city makes the hierarchy easy to see

IMAGINE WE ARE BUILDING A FUTURISTIC SUSTAINABLE CITY

Zoom out: the unit of management changes—and so does success.



01 PROJECT

ONE HOUSE

A defined output, delivered within scope, time, and budget.



02 PROGRAM

A NEIGHBORHOOD

Related projects coordinated to create a livable outcome.



03 PORTFOLIO

THE CITY STRATEGY

All investments balanced against priorities, capacity, and value.

DELIVER THE OUTPUT → REALIZE THE BENEFITS → ALLOCATE FOR STRATEGIC VALUE

NOTES — SLIDE 24

CITY ANALOGY

The house, neighborhood, and city analogy makes the change in management lens visible. The house represents a project: one defined output. The neighborhood represents a program: related components coordinated to create a livable outcome. The city strategy represents a portfolio: competing investments balanced against priorities, capacity, and risk.

The analogy also clarifies success. Projects emphasize delivery, programs emphasize combined benefits, and portfolios emphasize strategic value and balance.

STUDY TIP: Use analogies to remember the distinctions, then restate them using formal definitions.

REVIEW QUESTION: What would count as an operation within the city analogy?

The management lens changes as the scope expands

01

PROJECT

One house

NATURE

Temporary and unique

MANAGED THROUGH

Scope • schedule • budget

SUCCESS TEST

Did we deliver it right?

FOCUS

Efficiency and delivery

BUILD IT RIGHT

02

PROGRAM

The neighborhood

NATURE

Related projects working together

MANAGED THROUGH

Interdependencies • integration • benefits

SUCCESS TEST

Did the parts create the outcome?

FOCUS

Effectiveness and benefits

MAKE IT WORK TOGETHER

03

PORTFOLIO

The whole city

NATURE

A mix of investments and operations

MANAGED THROUGH

Prioritization • capacity • risk balance

SUCCESS TEST

Are we doing the right work?

FOCUS

Strategic alignment and value

CHOOSE THE RIGHT WORK

NOTES — SLIDE 25

THE MANAGEMENT LENS EXPANDS

As the scope expands from project to program to portfolio, the primary questions change. Project management asks whether the result can be delivered correctly within agreed constraints. Program management asks whether interdependent components collectively create the intended benefits. Portfolio management asks whether the organization is investing in the right work.

Each level requires different evidence: accepted outputs for projects, benefit realization for programs, and strategic alignment, balance, capacity, and risk for portfolios.

STUDY TIP: Remember the sequence: do things right, do things together, do the right things.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which level should resolve competition for resources among unrelated initiatives?

Are you managing a project, a program, or a portfolio?

Five scenarios. One management instinct.

01 DELIVER

02 COORDINATE

03 PRIORITIZE

04 BALANCE

05 CHOOSE

NOTES — SLIDE 26

QUIZ STRATEGY

The quiz tests whether you can classify work by its management objective. For each scenario, ignore the size of the initiative at first. Identify the dominant verb: deliver a unique result, coordinate related components, or prioritize investments.

Projects focus on delivery constraints and acceptance. Programs focus on interdependencies and shared benefits. Portfolios focus on selection, balance, capacity, risk, and strategic alignment.

STUDY TIP: State the reason before selecting the label.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which two levels are most easily confused, and what rule separates them?

WARM-UP

01

CHOOSE
ONE

SCENARIO

A company launches three electric car models, builds a battery factory, and creates a charging network—all managed together to dominate the EV market.

Read the management objective—not just the size of the work.

A A single big project

B A program

C A portfolio

WHY Related projects are coordinated to realize one shared strategic benefit.

NOTES — SLIDE 27

QUIZ 1: PROGRAM

The electric-car scenario is a program because several related projects—vehicle models, battery production, and charging infrastructure—must be coordinated to realize one shared strategic benefit. The work is not one indivisible deliverable, and the emphasis is not choosing among unrelated investments.

A program manager integrates dependencies, sequencing, shared resources, risks, stakeholders, and benefit realization across components.

STUDY TIP: Multiple projects alone do not create a program; the decisive feature is coordinated benefit.

REVIEW QUESTION: What shared benefit would justify managing these components together?

THE TRICK QUESTION

02

CHOOSE
ONE

SCENARIO

The CEO cancels a profitable video-game project and redirects all funding into artificial-intelligence research. This decision belongs to...

Read the management objective—not just the size of the work.

A Project management

B Program management

C Portfolio management

WHY This is strategic alignment and resource allocation across competing investments.

NOTES — SLIDE 28

QUIZ 2: PORTFOLIO

Cancelling one profitable initiative and redirecting funding to another field is a portfolio decision. The CEO is comparing investments against future strategy and reallocating scarce resources. The decision is not primarily about delivering either project or coordinating related components.

Portfolio management can stop a well-performing project when it no longer represents the best strategic use of capital, people, or risk capacity.

STUDY TIP: Project success does not guarantee continued portfolio priority.

REVIEW QUESTION: What evidence should support the decision to stop a profitable project?

FOCUS ON CONSTRAINTS

03

CHOOSE
ONE

SCENARIO

**Your team is running out of budget—
and the deadline is next Friday.
Which manager are you?**

Read the management objective—not just the size of
the work.

A Project manager**B** Program manager**C** Portfolio manager

WHY The immediate focus is the project constraint set:
scope, time, and cost.

NOTES — SLIDE 29

QUIZ 3: PROJECT

A team facing a near deadline and a depleted budget is dealing with project-level constraints. The immediate management task is to evaluate remaining scope, schedule, cost, quality, and risk; make trade-offs explicit; and escalate decisions when tolerances are exceeded.

The correct response is not simply to work faster. Reforecast, protect critical acceptance criteria, identify options, and obtain a decision from the appropriate authority.

STUDY TIP: Constraints trigger decisions, not automatic sacrifice of quality.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information should accompany a request for more time or budget?

FOCUS ON VALUE

04

CHOOSE
ONE

SCENARIO

A company has 20 active initiatives: IT upgrades, marketing campaigns, and an HR restructuring. They are independent, but draw from the same budget.

Read the management objective—not just the size of the work.

A A program

B A portfolio

C A project lifecycle

WHY Independent initiatives are grouped to support strategic goals and compete for shared resources.

NOTES — SLIDE 30

QUIZ 4: PORTFOLIO

The initiatives are independent but draw from the same budget. This makes the central problem portfolio management: how to select, prioritize, balance, and resource work that competes for organizational capacity.

A program would require meaningful interdependence or shared benefits among related components. Shared funding alone does not make independent initiatives a program.

STUDY TIP: Related benefits suggest a program; competition for resources and strategic priority suggests a portfolio.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which criteria could be used to rank these initiatives transparently?

THE BIG PICTURE

05

CHOOSE
ONE

SCENARIO

If a project focuses on “doing things right,” what is the primary focus of a portfolio?

Read the management objective—not just the size of the work.

A Doing things fast

B Doing things together

C Doing the right things

WHY Portfolio management chooses the initiatives that best advance the organization's future.

NOTES — SLIDE 31

QUIZ 5: STRATEGIC CHOICE

The phrase “doing the right things” describes portfolio management. Projects emphasize disciplined execution, while portfolios determine which investments best advance strategy and how the overall mix should be balanced.

A portfolio can include projects, programs, and other work. Its managers consider expected value, risk, dependencies, regulatory obligations, capacity, and strategic fit rather than evaluating initiatives in isolation.

STUDY TIP: Portfolio decisions are comparative: every approval has an opportunity cost.

REVIEW QUESTION: Why can “doing things fast” be harmful at portfolio level?

LESSON 01 • PRACTICE QUIZ

Solutions

Answers and reasoning for the practice questions

032

NOTES — SLIDE 32

QUIZ SOLUTIONS SECTION

Divider slide. Before revealing the answers, ask two or three students to justify their choice: the reasoning matters more than the letter. Then walk through the five scenarios and, for every rejected option, state the concept it actually describes.

Expected answers: 1 program, 2 portfolio, 3 project, 4 portfolio, 5 portfolio (“doing the right things”).

REVIEW QUESTION: Which two levels were most often confused, and what rule separates them?

Three levels. One management system.

Success requires execution, coordinated benefits, and strategic choice.

01

PROJECTS

DO THINGS RIGHT

EXECUTION

Deliver a specific result with discipline.

02

PROGRAMS

DO THINGS TOGETHER

BENEFITS

Coordinate related work so the whole delivers more.

03

PORTFOLIOS

DO THE RIGHT THINGS

STRATEGY

Select and balance work that advances the vision.

A perfect house in the wrong place is still the wrong investment.

NOTES — SLIDE 33

PROJECT, PROGRAM, PORTFOLIO SUMMARY

The three levels form one management system. Projects create specific results. Programs coordinate related work so combined benefits can emerge. Portfolios select and balance work to advance organizational strategy.

Good governance connects the levels. Project evidence informs program integration and benefit decisions; program and project evidence informs portfolio choices; portfolio priorities guide what work is authorized and resourced.

STUDY TIP: Memorize the logic, not only the labels: execution, benefits, strategy.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information should flow upward from a project to support portfolio decisions?



LESSON 01 • QUESTION

“Who is a Project Manager?”

NOTES — SLIDE 34

WHAT DOES A PROJECT MANAGER DO?

A project manager integrates work so that people can make timely, responsible decisions and deliver intended outcomes. The role is broader than scheduling meetings or updating a plan.

Core responsibilities include clarifying objectives and success criteria; coordinating scope, schedule, cost, quality, resources, risk, procurement, and stakeholders; maintaining a shared view of assumptions and dependencies; facilitating decisions and escalation; supporting team effectiveness; and connecting deliverables to outcomes and value.

The project manager does not personally make every decision. Authority belongs to the appropriate role: sponsors authorize and protect direction, product or business owners clarify value and priorities, specialists make technical judgments, operational owners sustain benefits, and governance bodies resolve decisions within their mandate. The project manager makes this decision system visible and integrated.

STUDY TIP: Distinguish accountability from control. Effective project management creates transparency, forecasts consequences, and escalates when thresholds are exceeded — it does not centralize all authority in one person.

REVIEW QUESTION: Ask the class for their own definition first, then compare it with this one: what did they leave out?

The project manager turns ambiguity into coordinated action

NOT A CHECKLIST. A CATALYST.

Translate an abstract idea into a structured reality.

The project manager bridges executive intent and technical execution—speaking both languages and creating the conditions for delivery.

The role spans the entire lifecycle, from defining the work to delivering value.

FROM INTENT

“Build a new mobile banking app.”



TO DELIVERY

Scope, plan, coordination, decisions, and value.



THE FILM DIRECTOR: align the specialists without doing every specialist's job.

NOTES — SLIDE 35

THE PROJECT MANAGER AS INTEGRATOR

The project manager turns an abstract intention into coordinated action. The role is not limited to schedules or checklists: it integrates decisions, people, information, constraints, risks, and stakeholder expectations across the lifecycle.

The manager translates between executive intent and technical execution. This requires enough business understanding to protect value, enough delivery knowledge to structure the work, and enough leadership skill to create alignment without relying only on formal authority.

STUDY TIP: Describe the role with integration verbs: clarify, align, coordinate, decide, communicate, learn, and adapt.

REVIEW QUESTION: Where does coordination add more value than individual technical expertise?

Effective project managers combine three capability sets

01

WAYS OF WORKING

Select and tailor predictive or adaptive approaches.

PROOF IN PRACTICE

PLANNING • DELIVERY • RISK • QUALITY • CHANGE

DECISION RULE

02

POWER SKILLS

Lead collaboratively and communicate with influence.

PROOF IN PRACTICE

COMMUNICATION • PROBLEM-SOLVING • EMPATHY • STRATEGIC THINKING

03

BUSINESS ACUMEN

Connect project choices to strategy and value.

PROOF IN PRACTICE

CONTEXT • PRIORITIES • INVESTMENT • BENEFITS

Use the right method, with the right people, for the right value.

NOTES — SLIDE 36

HOME STUDY — PROJECT MANAGER CAPABILITIES

Use the PMI Talent Triangle® to organize your development.

WAYS OF WORKING covers the practices used to deliver: predictive, adaptive, hybrid, design-thinking, and other fit-for-purpose approaches. Competence means selecting and tailoring methods to the project's uncertainty, feedback needs, constraints, and governance — not applying one method everywhere.

POWER SKILLS are the behaviors that make coordinated work possible: collaborative leadership, communication, problem-solving, empathy, conflict navigation, and strategic thinking. They help the project manager build trust, influence stakeholders without relying only on formal authority, and hold productive conversations about difficult trade-offs.

BUSINESS ACUMEN connects project decisions to organizational strategy and stakeholder value. It requires understanding the operating context, priorities, investment logic, expected benefits, and external forces that may change the case for the project.

HOME ACTIVITY: Choose a familiar project and make three short lists — one method you would tailor, one conversation you would lead, one business outcome you would protect. Then identify your strongest capability set and one behavior to practise in the next team assignment.

REVIEW QUESTION: Why is strength in only one capability set insufficient? A strong answer shows how methods, relationships, and business value reinforce one another.

Hard skills provide the blueprint and the compass

Technical disciplines turn intent into a plan—and keep delivery under control.

THE BLUEPRINT

Define the work before the work defines you.

Break the project into manageable tasks, sequence the effort, clarify ownership, and establish a delivery baseline.

A strong plan makes trade-offs visible.

THE COMPASS

01 PLANNING Scope • schedule • resources

02 DELIVERY Progress • coordination • decisions

03 RISK Threats • responses • escalation

04 QUALITY Acceptance • fitness for purpose

05 CHANGE Impact • options • control

Hard skills help the team see where it is—and what must change.

NOTES — SLIDE 37

HARD SKILLS AS BLUEPRINT AND COMPASS

Hard skills provide the structures used to define, plan, monitor, and control work. The blueprint includes scope decomposition, sequencing, estimation, ownership, budget, quality criteria, and baselines. The compass uses evidence from progress, risk, issues, change, and performance to guide decisions.

Tools are not ends in themselves. A plan is valuable when it makes assumptions, dependencies, trade-offs, and decision points visible. Control means comparing evidence with expectations and adapting responsibly—not forcing reality to match an obsolete baseline.

STUDY TIP: For every artifact, ask which decision it supports.

REVIEW QUESTION: What is the difference between maintaining a baseline and refusing to adapt?

Soft skills are the project manager's real operating system

THE HUMAN SIDE OF DELIVERY

90%

OF A PROJECT MANAGER'S TIME IS SPENT COMMUNICATING —
WIDELY CITED PMI ESTIMATE

**Plans do not deliver projects.
People do.**

Communication turns information into alignment.
Influence turns alignment into action. Empathy keeps
action sustainable.

Lead the room—even without formal authority.

- | | | |
|----|--------------------|--|
| 01 | COMMUNICATION | Make goals, decisions, and risks clear. |
| 02 | INFLUENCE | Build commitment across boundaries. |
| 03 | PROBLEM-SOLVING | Turn uncertainty into practical choices. |
| 04 | EMPATHY | Read concerns before they become resistance. |
| 05 | STRATEGIC THINKING | Connect daily work to intended value. |

THE BEST PROJECT MANAGERS CREATE CLARITY, TRUST, AND MOMENTUM.

NOTES — SLIDE 38

SOFT SKILLS AS THE OPERATING SYSTEM

Projects are delivered through people, so communication, influence, empathy, collaboration, and conflict management are core delivery capabilities. Communication creates shared understanding; influence builds commitment; empathy reveals concerns and constraints; collaboration integrates specialist knowledge.

Soft skills do not replace accountability. They help the project manager surface disagreement, make decisions understandable, negotiate trade-offs, and sustain productive relationships—especially where authority is shared.

STUDY TIP: Match the skill to the situation: inform, listen, facilitate, negotiate, coach, or escalate.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which soft skill is most important when stakeholders agree on the goal but disagree on priorities?

Conclusion: Your Future as a PM

WHAT THE ROLE IS NOT

To wrap up, being a Project Manager is not about knowing how to do everyone else's job. You don't need to be the best coder to manage a software project, nor the best architect to build a skyscraper.

YOU ARE ALREADY PRACTISING IT

As university students, you are already practicing these skills today. Every time you manage a group assignment, divide tasks, deal with a lazy teammate, and race against a midnight deadline, you are doing project management.

YOUR JOB

Your job is to orchestrate. You create the environment where experts can do their best work, together, on time, and on budget.

NOTES — SLIDE 39

ORCHESTRATING EXPERT WORK

A project manager does not need to be the strongest technical specialist in every discipline. The role is to create the conditions in which experts can contribute effectively: a clear outcome, explicit responsibilities, realistic interfaces, timely decisions, visible risks, and constructive collaboration.

University group work already provides practice in project leadership. Dividing tasks, integrating contributions, resolving conflict, and protecting deadlines are small-scale examples of coordination and governance.

STUDY TIP: Evaluate leadership by the quality of the system and team performance, not by how much work the manager personally completes.

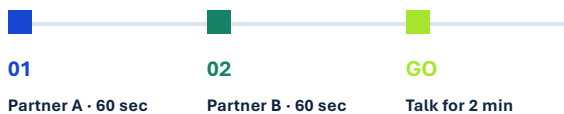
REVIEW QUESTION: What should a project manager understand about technical work without becoming the technical expert?

ROLE PLAY: Build the plan—and anticipate the people challenges

Turn to the person sitting next to you. You are now a team.

CHALLENGE

Apple wants to launch a revolutionary holographic iPhone in exactly 18 months.



Go! You have 2 minutes to talk to each other.

A HARD SKILLS SPECIALIST

60 SECONDS

List at least 3 technical constraints or processes you need to plan.

Examples: budget, suppliers, testing phases.

B SOFT SKILLS SPECIALIST

60 SECONDS

List 3 human challenges you will face.

Examples: team burnout, conflicting ideas, convincing Tim Cook.

NOTES — SLIDE 40

HARD AND SOFT SKILLS EXERCISE

The holographic-phone scenario separates two complementary planning perspectives. Hard-skill analysis identifies constraints and processes such as budget, suppliers, architecture, testing, quality, regulation, schedule, and risk. Soft-skill analysis identifies human challenges such as conflict, uncertainty, stakeholder expectations, cross-functional coordination, and resistance.

After listing items, connect them. Every technical issue has a people and decision dimension; every people issue can affect time, cost, scope, quality, or risk.

STUDY TIP: Convert each item into an owner, evidence source, and next decision.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which technical risk is most dependent on effective communication?

“This exercise proves that a project cannot survive without both. You need the plan, but you also need the people. That is the true essence of Project Management.”

Plan and people are not alternatives — they are the two halves of delivery.

NOTES — SLIDE 41

PLAN AND PEOPLE

The exercise demonstrates that project performance depends on both structured delivery practices and human collaboration. A technically excellent plan fails if people do not understand, accept, or coordinate it. Strong relationships without clear scope, decisions, and controls can also fail.

Integration is the project manager's core contribution: connecting plans with behavior, expertise with decisions, and constraints with value.

STUDY TIP: When diagnosing a project problem, check both the delivery system and the social system.

REVIEW QUESTION: Give one failure caused mainly by weak planning and one caused mainly by weak collaboration.

01

AUTHORITY & STRUCTURE

PM's authority and structure

How organizational structure decides the power a project manager really has.

NOTES — SLIDE 42

AUTHORITY AND ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

This section examines how organizational structure affects the project manager's formal authority, access to resources, and escalation paths. The central question is who controls people, budgets, priorities, and technical decisions.

In a functional structure, authority remains mainly with functional managers and the project manager coordinates through negotiation. In a matrix, authority is shared and decision rights must be explicit. In a projectized structure, resources and accountability are organized around the project, so the project manager typically has greater formal authority.

STUDY TIP: Do not infer actual authority from a title alone. Examine reporting lines, resource ownership, governance rules, and sponsor support.

REVIEW QUESTION: Before planning starts, which five questions would tell you how much authority you actually hold?

Three structures, three very different PMs

The same job title carries a different mandate in each organizational model.

FUNCTIONAL

The powerless PM

Role: Almost zero formal authority. The team reports 100% to their department bosses.

Analogy: A wedding coordinator who must ask the bride's parents.

Skill: Extreme negotiation and patience — you manage schedules, not people.

MATRIX

The Equilibrist PM

Role: Authority is shared. Employees report both to their function and to the PM.

Nuance: Weak matrix — the department boss wins. Strong matrix — the PM owns budget and timeline.

Skill: Corporate diplomacy, conflict resolution, influence without authority.

PROJECTIZED

The sovereign PM

Role: Absolute authority. The team reports directly to the PM for the whole project.

Analogy: A film director — if the director says “change the scene,” it changes.

Flip side: Total accountability, and the team dissolves when the project ends.



Authority follows resources: the closer the team sits to the project, the more power the PM holds.

NOTES — SLIDE 43

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURES

Walk the continuum. In a FUNCTIONAL structure the functional manager holds the authority and the project manager acts as a coordinator with little formal power. In a MATRIX structure authority is shared — weak, balanced or strong, depending on how much control the project manager has over budget and people. In a PROJECTIZED structure the project manager holds full authority and the team reports directly to them.

Stress that the project manager's real leverage depends on the structure, not on the job title. The trade-off is symmetrical: more authority also means fuller accountability, and in a projectized organization the team dissolves when the project closes.

STUDY TIP: For each model, name who assigns work, who controls specialist capacity, and who resolves priority conflicts.

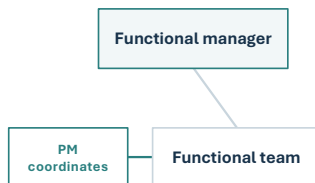
REVIEW QUESTION: In which structure does a project manager most depend on influence rather than formal authority, and what would you negotiate first?

Structure determines the PM's authority

Authority increases as resources and accountability move toward the project.

01 FUNCTIONAL

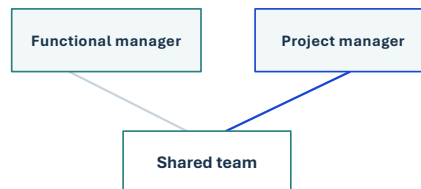
PM coordinates outside the resource line



LOW AUTHORITY

02 MATRIX

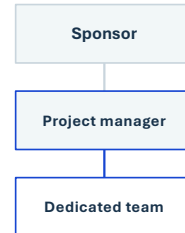
Authority is shared across two lines



SHARED AUTHORITY

03 PROJECTIZED

The PM leads a dedicated delivery line



HIGH AUTHORITY

Read the chart first: who assigns work, controls resources, and resolves conflict?

NOTES — SLIDE 44

READING ORGANIZATION CHARTS

The three diagrams translate organizational structure into reporting and coordination relationships. Read each chart by tracing who controls resources, who assigns work, and where unresolved conflict is escalated. In the functional model, the project manager works across the resource line and depends on functional managers. In the matrix model, team members operate across two lines, so shared authority must be made explicit. In the projectized model, the sponsor authorizes the work and the project manager leads a dedicated delivery team.

Dashed or coordination relationships can be as important as solid reporting lines because many project decisions cross formal boundaries. An organization chart does not, by itself, explain every decision right; it should be supplemented with governance agreements, role descriptions, or a responsibility matrix. Use the diagram as a prompt for questions rather than assuming that job titles reveal actual authority.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which relationship in each chart is most likely to create delay, and what governance rule could reduce it?

01

PMO & GOVERNANCE

PMO – Project Management Office

Understand how a PMO supports, governs, or directs delivery.

What mandate, position, and operating model fit?

NOTES — SLIDE 45

INTRODUCTION TO THE PMO

A Project Management Office is an organizational structure that supports, governs, integrates, or sometimes directly manages project-related work. The label “PMO” is not sufficient to understand its authority. You must examine its mandate, reporting line, customers, services, decision rights, and measures of success.

A PMO can create value by improving decision quality, consistency, transparency, capability, and alignment with organizational priorities. It can also create unnecessary bureaucracy if processes are not proportional to risk and information needs. The correct design depends on the organization's context: number and complexity of initiatives, regulatory exposure, resource constraints, maturity, and need for coordination. The following slides distinguish mandate, position, and operating model because each answers a different design question.

STUDY TIP: Describe a PMO with verbs—advise, assure, integrate, decide, or deliver—rather than with a generic title.

REVIEW QUESTION: What problem should a PMO solve before its structure and services are designed?

A PMO creates one language for delivery

PMO DEFINITION

A management structure that standardizes project-related governance processes and facilitates the sharing of resources, methodologies, tools, and techniques.

WHY IT EXISTS

Large organizations run hundreds—or thousands—of projects. Without shared methods, leadership cannot compare cost, progress, risk, or quality.

WITHOUT A PMO

Different tools

Different cost logic

Different reports

Local quality rules

WITH A PMO

Common tools

Comparable data

Standard reporting

Shared quality standards

Four typical functions: governance • enablement • integration • strategic alignment — one operating language executives can trust.

NOTES — SLIDE 46

ONE LANGUAGE FOR DELIVERY

A PMO creates consistency by defining shared methods, terminology, information, tools, and governance practices. This makes projects comparable and improves handovers, escalation, portfolio visibility, and organizational learning.

Standardization should be proportional. The goal is not identical paperwork for every initiative but reliable information and repeatable decision processes appropriate to risk and complexity.

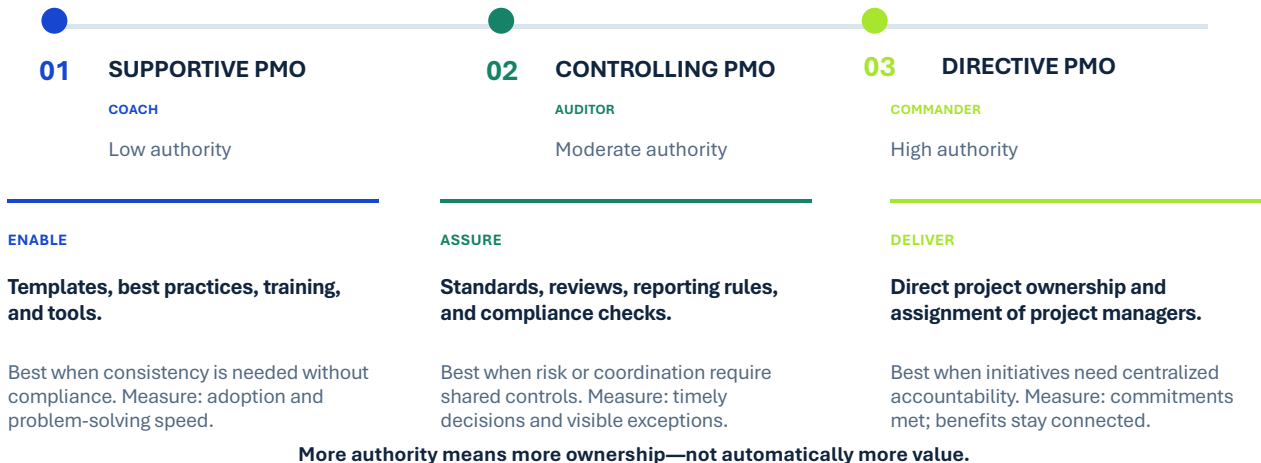
STUDY TIP: Distinguish standardization of essential information from unnecessary uniformity of every activity.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which three data elements must be consistent before leadership can compare projects?

TYPICAL FUNCTIONS. Governance defines decision rights, standards, controls, escalation paths and assurance. Enablement provides methods, templates, tools, coaching, knowledge and shared resources. Integration consolidates data, dependencies, risks, capacity and performance information. Strategic alignment connects initiatives to objectives, value, benefits and investment priorities. A PMO adds value when it improves decisions and delivery; bureaucracy without decision value is not success.

PMO authority ranges from coach to commander

The right model depends on organizational maturity and how much control the PMO is expected to exercise.



NOTES — SLIDE 47

PMO AUTHORITY SPECTRUM

Supportive, controlling, and directive PMOs differ mainly in mandate and authority. A supportive PMO advises and enables through templates, training, coaching, and tools. A controlling PMO establishes guardrails and verifies compliance. A directive PMO directly manages projects or assigns project managers.

No model is universally best. The fit depends on organizational maturity, regulatory exposure, delivery risk, strategic importance, and the need for consistency or direct control.

STUDY TIP: Describe each type using a verb: support, assure, or direct.

REVIEW QUESTION: When would a directive PMO create more value than a supportive PMO?

CROSS-CUTTING MODEL. An Agile Center of Excellence sits across the three archetypes: coaching, practice development, communities and experimentation — without automatically owning governance or delivery. Real PMOs often combine archetypes; what must be explicit is the authority, the customers, the services and the measures.

Standardization, governance, and visibility make delivery scalable

A PMO converts fragmented project activity into an enterprise management system.

01

STANDARDIZATION

Consistency

Common methods and documentation let work continue when people change.

Same language • smoother handovers

02

GOVERNANCE

Decision quality

Health checks and reliable data help leaders continue, correct, or stop work.

Evidence • escalation • control

03

VISIBILITY

Executive insight

Project data is synthesized into a portfolio-level view of performance and risk.

Clarity • comparison • foresight

PROJECT MANAGERS

deliver the project

THE PMO

protects the health of all projects

NOTES — SLIDE 48

HOW A PMO CREATES VALUE

A PMO can make delivery scalable through standardization, governance, and visibility. Standardization creates a common language and reusable practices. Governance improves decision quality through thresholds, assurance, and escalation. Visibility gives leaders reliable information about progress, risk, capacity, and value.

The PMO should measure outcomes, not only activity. Template usage or report production matters only if it improves decisions, delivery capability, or strategic alignment.

STUDY TIP: Link each PMO service to a customer, a decision, and a measurable improvement.

REVIEW QUESTION: What metric would distinguish useful governance from bureaucracy?

PMO position determines its line of sight

Position determines the PMO's decision horizon, authority, customers, and definition of success.

ENTERPRISE / STRATEGIC PMO REPORTS TO • Executive leadership / COO	LINE OF SIGHT Whole portfolio and strategic priorities	ROLE Align investments, set enterprise standards, balance capacity, and escalate portfolio trade-offs.
BUSINESS-UNIT / DEPARTMENTAL PMO REPORTS TO • Function or division leader	LINE OF SIGHT One unit's portfolio and shared resources	ROLE Translate strategy into a delivery roadmap, govern dependencies, allocate unit capacity, and coach teams.
PROJECT / PROGRAM OFFICE REPORTS TO • Sponsor or program manager	LINE OF SIGHT One major initiative and its components	ROLE Integrate plans, controls, information, risks, interfaces, and decision follow-through close to delivery.

Design principle: position follows mandate — never give a PMO more responsibility than its reporting line can support.

Sources: PMI — Which PMO Is Right; PMI PMO Frameworks; APM — What is a PMO?

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 49

PMO POSITION IN THE ORGANIZATION

Position determines the PMO's line of sight, customers, decision horizon and realistic authority. An enterprise or strategic PMO reports near executive leadership and focuses on the whole portfolio, strategic alignment, investment trade-offs, capacity and enterprise standards. A business-unit PMO translates priorities into a governed roadmap for one division and coordinates shared resources and dependencies. A project or program office works close to one major initiative, integrating plans, controls, risks, interfaces and decision follow-through.

Responsibility must not exceed the authority provided by the reporting line. A program office can consolidate accurate information but may be unable to rebalance investment across the enterprise; an enterprise PMO should avoid becoming detached from delivery realities. Effective design establishes information flows and escalation paths across levels.

STUDY TIP: For each position, identify the decisions it can make, those it can only recommend, and those it can only be informed about.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information should flow from a program office to an enterprise PMO, and what decisions should flow back?

Central, embedded, or hub-and-spoke?

Choose the structure that places support close enough to delivery without losing enterprise coherence.

CENTRAL

ONE PMO • MANY TEAMS

Most capability sits outside delivery teams and serves multiple projects.

WORKS BEST WHEN

Best when many smaller initiatives need shared standards, flexible support, and consistent information.

DESIGN RISK

Watch for distance from day-to-day delivery.

EMBEDDED

ONE INITIATIVE • DEDICATED PMO

PMO capability works under the project or program leadership.

WORKS BEST WHEN

Best when a large, complex initiative needs intensive planning, controls, coordination, and specialist support.

DESIGN RISK

Watch for duplication and local optimization.

HUB-AND-SPOKE

CENTRAL CORE • LOCAL SATELLITES

A central enterprise or portfolio PMO links to PMOs near programs, functions, or regions.

WORKS BEST WHEN

Best when the organization needs common governance plus context-sensitive support close to the work.

DESIGN RISK

Watch for unclear decision rights between hub and spokes.

Sources: APM — What is a PMO?; PMI — PMO Frameworks

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 50

PMO OPERATING MODELS

The operating model determines where PMO capability sits relative to delivery teams. A central model concentrates expertise and services in one office, promoting consistency, flexible support and consolidated information; its risk is distance from daily work. An embedded model places dedicated PMO capability inside a major project or program, enabling intensive coordination and rapid support; its risks are duplication and local optimization. A hub-and-spoke model combines a central core with local PMOs, balancing enterprise coherence with contextual support.

Choose the model by considering initiative scale, geographic or functional diversity, need for standardization, specialist capacity and decision speed. Structure alone does not solve coordination: roles, data ownership, service expectations, funding, escalation and performance measures must be explicit. Hybrid arrangements are common, but ambiguity between hub and spokes creates duplicated reporting and slow decisions.

STUDY TIP: Before choosing a model, write down which decisions must be identical everywhere and which may legitimately differ by context.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which operating model best fits a university with common governance but highly autonomous faculties, and what decision rights must be clarified?

HOW TO CHOOSE. Many initiatives needing consistency: central. One large, complex initiative: embedded. Scale plus strong local differences: hub-and-spoke. In every model, decision rights, data ownership and escalation paths must be written down, otherwise the structure simply relocates the ambiguity. **STUDY TIP:** for each model, name one decision the PMO can make and one it can only recommend.

01

30 Sep 2026

COMMUNICATION & REQUIREMENTS

Visual Board Technique

Turn an idea into a shared product vision.

How can the team make the idea visible and aligned?

LESSON 01 • PMI; ISO 21502

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 51

VISUAL BOARD TECHNIQUE

A visual board makes an emerging product or service idea visible, discussable, and testable. Its purpose is not decoration. It creates a shared object around which the team can expose assumptions, compare interpretations, identify gaps, and make decisions. This is especially useful early in a project, when words such as “simple,” “innovative,” or “user-friendly” may hide very different expectations.

The board should connect the target group, needs, proposed product, expected value, and major barriers. Keep the first version deliberately rough so that participants feel able to challenge it. Use short statements and concrete evidence rather than long descriptions. Differences between team members are valuable because they reveal misalignment before expensive design or development begins. The board should evolve as learning increases, but the team must record important decisions and unresolved assumptions.

STUDY TIP: Treat every item as a hypothesis that can be validated.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which part of a vision board is most likely to expose disagreement, and how should the team resolve it?

LESSON 01 • QUESTION

“How to share the idea of product/service we have in mind?”

LESSON 01 • CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

NOTES — SLIDE 52

SHARING A PRODUCT OR SERVICE IDEA

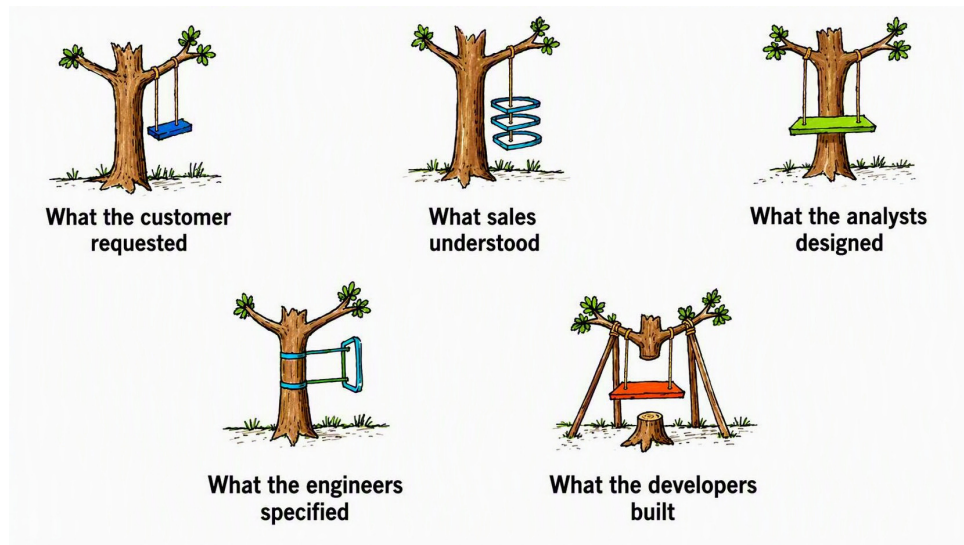
A team cannot coordinate effectively when each member holds a different mental model of the proposed solution. Sharing an idea requires more than presenting features. The team must explain who the product or service is for, what need or opportunity matters, what change is intended, which capabilities are essential, and why the idea is valuable compared with alternatives.

Visual techniques support this conversation because they externalize assumptions. A sketch, Vision Board, Product Vision Box, or positioning statement gives participants something concrete to question and improve. The goal is not immediate agreement; it is informed alignment. Encourage participants to ask what evidence supports the target group, whether features connect to needs, which benefits are expected, and what is deliberately outside scope. A strong shared vision guides later priorities and trade-offs.

EXAMPLE: “A mobile app for students” is too vague; a useful vision names the student group, problem, benefit, and differentiation.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information must be shared before a team can prioritize features responsibly?

The “tree swing” problem: five interpretations, one failed outcome



Lesson: validate shared understanding before designing or building.

APPLIED PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 53

THE TREE-SWING PROBLEM

The tree-swing illustration shows how a single request can be interpreted differently by customers, sales, analysts, engineers, and developers. Each participant may act reasonably from a local perspective while the final result fails to satisfy the actual need. The problem is not simply poor communication; it is the absence of shared validation, explicit assumptions, and feedback throughout the work.

Use the illustration to distinguish stated requirements from underlying needs. A customer's first description may be incomplete or solution-biased. Teams should explore context, users, constraints, desired outcomes, acceptance criteria, and examples. Prototypes and incremental reviews reduce the cost of misunderstanding because they make interpretations visible before full implementation. Documentation helps, but it cannot replace conversation and observation.

STUDY TIP: Translate a vague request into a user need, an outcome, a constraint, and a testable acceptance criterion.

REVIEW QUESTION: At which points in the project should shared understanding be validated, and what artifact or conversation would you use?

Vision Board Guidelines

Use the board to align the team around four questions before writing the vision statement.

01 TARGET GROUP

Who is it for?

Identify broad end-user categories. Start at the macro level; refine or combine segments as the vision becomes clearer.

02 NEEDS

What must change?

Name at least one need or problem for each target group. If needs differ significantly, reconsider how the groups are structured.

03 PRODUCT

What will we offer?

Select 3–5 essential features. Prioritize the distinctive capabilities that matter most—not the obvious basics.

04 BUSINESS VALUE

What value will it create?

Define the expected outcome: revenue, cost savings, market share, service quality, or customer satisfaction.

SYNTHESIZE

VISION STATEMENT

Turn the four perspectives into one memorable sentence that everyone can repeat and use to guide decisions.

NOTES — SLIDE 54

VISION BOARD GUIDELINES

The Vision Board aligns a team around four connected questions before detailed requirements are written. **TARGET GROUP** identifies who experiences the need or is affected by the solution. **NEEDS** describe the problem, desired change, or job to be done. **PRODUCT** defines the essential offer and its distinguishing capabilities. **BUSINESS VALUE** explains why the initiative matters to the organization or society.

Complete the fields as hypotheses, not unquestionable facts. Avoid jumping directly from a vague audience to a long feature list. Each feature should respond to a validated need and contribute to an intended outcome or benefit. The final vision statement condenses the logic into a sentence the team can remember and use in decisions.

STUDY TIP: Check the chain: target group → need → product capability → expected value.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which field should be revisited if two target groups have substantially different needs?

A car when you need it. Pay only when you use it.

App-based Car access creates a new urban mobility market—while improving rental economics.

01 AUDIENCE

Flexible access—not ownership.

- Avoid public transit or using their own car
- People without a car
- Drivers who need a car occasionally

OUT OF SCOPE

People without a driving licence

02 NEEDS

Fast access. Zero friction.

- A nearby car—always available
- Paperwork-free rental
- Access to restricted zones
- Pay only for time used
- Flexible parking with no extra fees

03 PRODUCT

Cars + mobile app.

- Cars available within a 1 km walk
- Use the app to locate, reserve and unlock
- Park citywide

04 BUSINESS VALUE

Build a new mobility category.

- Let potential buyers experience
- Expand the rental market
- Improve margins over daily rental

VISION BOARD EXAMPLE

055

NOTES — SLIDE 55

VISION BOARD EXAMPLE

The car-sharing example shows how the Vision Board connects a target group, user needs, the proposed product, and business value. The sequence matters: begin with who experiences the problem and what must change before listing features.

A strong board distinguishes needs from solutions. “Access a nearby car quickly” is a need; app-based vehicle access is a solution. Features should be justified by the outcomes and benefits they enable for users and the organization.

STUDY TIP: Test every feature with the question “Which need does this serve, and what evidence would show improvement?”

REVIEW QUESTION: Which assumption in the example should be tested first?

Workshop 2: Visual Board

Map output, outcome, benefit and metric.

Build a shared vision.

01 TARGET GROUP

02 NEEDS

03 PRODUCT

04 BUSINESS VALUE

NOTES — SLIDE 56

WORKSHOP 2: VISUAL BOARD

PURPOSE. Teams build a Visual Board that makes the chain from output to value explicit, so anyone can read the intent of the initiative without a presenter. The required output is a completed board, not a polished deck.

THE FOUR FIELDS. **TARGET GROUP:** who experiences the need or is affected by the solution. **NEEDS:** the problem, the desired change, or the job to be done — stated as a need, not as a feature. **PRODUCT:** the essential offer and the capabilities that distinguish it. **BUSINESS VALUE:** the benefit the organisation expects, with a measure attached.

HOW TO RUN IT (30 minutes). 5 minutes to agree the concept; 15 minutes to populate the four fields in order, left to right; 5 minutes to map each output to an outcome, a benefit and a metric; 5 minutes to present the board in one sentence.

FACILITATION TIPS. Expect to revisit earlier fields as the team learns. State explicitly who is out of scope. Challenge any benefit without a metric, and any metric nobody owns.

COMMON PITFALLS. Jumping straight to features; mixing needs with solutions; value statements that restate the output instead of the change it produces.

DEBRIEF. Each team reads its board aloud in under a minute. The group checks one question only: does the metric prove the benefit?

Build a shared vision: Vision Board

Map output, outcome, benefit and metric.

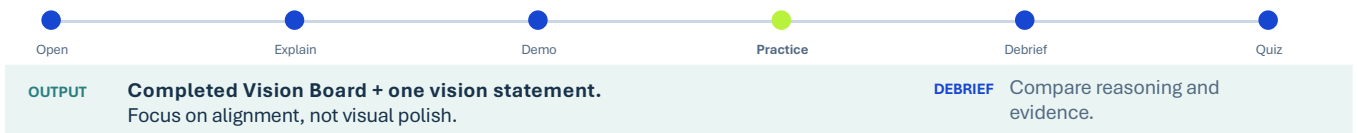
30
MINUTES



Work in groups. Imagine you are preparing the launch of a new product, service, or solution. Use the Vision Board to align the team, then present the concept to the class.

TEAM TASKS

- 1 Choose a familiar product, service, or solution and agree on its purpose.
- 2 Complete the Vision Board: target group, needs, product, business value, and barriers.
- 3 Write a one-sentence vision statement the whole team can repeat.
- 4 Prepare a 5 minute presentation. Every team member should be ready to explain the choices.



PMI Lexicon v5.0; PMBOK® Guide, 8th ed.

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NOTES — SLIDE 57

IN-CLASS VISION BOARD EXERCISE

PURPOSE. Teams turn a familiar product, service or solution into a shared vision that anyone can read without a presenter. The required output is a completed Vision Board and one vision statement — not a polished deck. The Product Vision Box is introduced in the self-study section.

HOW TO RUN IT (30 minutes). 5 minutes to agree the concept and its purpose; 15 minutes to fill the four fields — target group, needs, product, business value — plus barriers and who is out of scope; 5 minutes for the vision statement; 5 minutes to prepare a five-minute presentation in which every member can explain a choice.

QUALITY CHECK. Insist on the chain: each feature must answer a stated need, each value claim must follow from an outcome, each barrier must become an assumption or an action. Push back on "everyone" as a target group and on unsupported claims such as "improves satisfaction".

DEBRIEF. Compare reasoning, not formatting. Ask whether the causal links are credible, whether the value has an owner, and which trade-offs the team accepted.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which field of your board would an outsider misread first, and how would you make it unambiguous?

Vision Board template

Describe the purpose of the product or service in one sentence.

01 TARGET GROUP	02 NEEDS	03 PRODUCT	04 BUSINESS VALUE
Identify the target audience and every stakeholder impacted.	What needs does the product satisfy?	List the product features.	Describe the value it creates for society.
		FEATURE 1	Examples: profit, internal KPIs, cost savings or market positioning.
		FEATURE 2	
		FEATURE 3	
WHO IS OUT? Specify who is excluded from this target.	BARRIERS Obstacles to satisfying these needs.		BARRIERS Barriers to value creation.

NOTES — SLIDE 58

USING THE VISION BOARD TEMPLATE

Complete the Vision Board from left to right, but expect to revisit earlier fields as the team learns. Begin with a one-sentence purpose that describes the intended change rather than the solution alone. Identify target groups and explicitly state who is outside the initial scope. Describe needs in the users' language, then select only the few product features that are essential to address those needs. Finally, define business or societal value and the barriers that could prevent realization.

Quality depends on the links between fields. Every feature should address a stated need; every value claim should follow from an outcome; every barrier should lead to an assumption, risk, or action. Avoid broad categories such as "everyone" and unsupported claims such as "improves satisfaction." Make the board specific enough to guide trade-offs while remaining easy to revise.

EXAMPLE: A campus-navigation service may target first-year students, address orientation anxiety, and measure reduced late arrivals.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which feature would you remove first if it does not connect clearly to a target-group need?

How your Vision Board will be assessed

FOUR CRITERIA • 100 POINTS

- 1 1 • TARGET & NEEDS — 25 points**
Groups are specific, each need is stated as a problem to solve, and who is out of scope is explicit.
- 2 2 • PRODUCT & VALUE — 35 points**
Three to five essential features, each traceable to a need, and value expressed with an indicator, a baseline and an owner.
- 3 3 • VISION STATEMENT — 30 points**
One sentence the whole team can repeat: specific, credible, with no unsupported claims.
- 4 4 • PEER REVIEW — 10 points**
Quality of the review you gave: specific, criteria-based feedback and one concrete improvement agreed with the other team.

PERFORMANCE LEVELS

- Excellent (90–100): specific, evidence-based, fully traceable
- Good (75–89): clear logic, some generic statements
- Sufficient (60–74): complete but weakly supported
- Insufficient (below 60): features with no need, or value with no owner

AUTOMATIC REWORK

A board is returned when a feature cannot be traced back to a stated need, or when a value claim has no owner and no indicator. Bring your peer-review notes with the final board.

NOTES — SLIDE 59

USING THE RUBRIC

Show this page in class so the criteria are known before the work starts, then use the rubric again before submitting, not after. Read your board criterion by criterion and mark, for each feature, the need it serves; delete any feature that cannot be linked. Then check that every value claim names an indicator, a baseline and an accountable owner. Visual polish carries no points: the assessment rewards traceable reasoning.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which criterion would your current board score lowest on, and what single change would raise it?



Thanks!

END OF THE IN-CLASS LESSON

Now it's your turn.

Part 02 — Self-study starts on the next slide.



059

NOTES — SLIDE 60

END OF THE IN-CLASS SESSION

This slide closes the 120-minute classroom lesson. Everything that follows is study material: the self-study section (guided plan, key definitions, rubric, knowledge check and answer keys) and the study extension (project success beyond delivery, and the PMBOK® Guide 8th edition).

Before leaving, restate the three takeaways and the deadline: the value chain and the Vision Board are due within seven days, before Lesson 02 (07 Oct), on Moodle — self-enrolment key PM2026.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which single idea from today would you use tomorrow on a piece of work you are already doing?

02

PART 02 • SELF-STUDY

Material for student study

Guided plan, glossary, rubric, question bank and readings. Every slide carries full study notes.

≈ 2 H 15

Estimated workload (plus an optional extension), spread over the week before Lesson 02.

WHAT YOU PRODUCE

A completed Vision Board and a positioning statement for your own idea.

HOW YOU CHECK

Self-check prompts, a 9-question bank with answer key, and the rubric.

060

NOTES — SLIDE 61

SELF-STUDY SECTION — HOW TO USE IT

This section is designed for independent work after the class. It follows the same sequence as the lesson: consolidate the concepts, apply one tool, then test recall. Start from the study plan, keep the glossary open while reading, use the rubric before submitting the Vision Board, and finish with the knowledge check without notes.

How to study Lesson 01 after class

STUDY PLAN — ABOUT 2 H 15

- 1** **1 • REVIEW (45 min • steps 1–2)**
Re-read this section and the speaker notes. Rewrite every definition in your own words, with one example and one non-example.
- 2** **2 • APPLY (40 min • step 5)**
Take one real initiative. Build its value chain and complete a Vision Board with the template from class.
- 3** **3 • TEST (45 min • steps 3–4)**
Answer the self-check and the nine knowledge-check questions from memory, then correct yourself with the answer key.

WHAT YOU SHOULD PRODUCE

- One-page value chain: output → outcome → benefit → value
- One completed Vision Board plus a one-sentence vision statement
- Written answers to the five self-check questions
- A short list of terms you still cannot explain without notes
- Your work scored against the assessment rubric

DEADLINE

Finish within seven days, before Lesson 02 (07 Oct).
Spaced review: day 1 REVIEW • day 3 APPLY • day 7 TEST.

NOTES — SLIDE 62

HOW TO USE THIS SECTION

Space the three blocks over at least two sessions: retrieval works better after a delay than in one long sitting. In REVIEW, do not reread passively; close the slide and explain the concept aloud before checking. In APPLY, choose an initiative you actually know, so that assumptions can be tested. In TEST, record your confidence before checking the key: high confidence with a wrong answer marks your first revision priority.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of the five required outputs is hardest for you to produce, and what is missing?

Key definitions: PMI vocabulary and course terminology

PMI Lexicon of Project Management Terms, v5.0; PMBOK® Guide, 8th ed.; ISO 21502:2020 — learn each term with one example, one non-example and the decision it supports.

PROJECT

temporary • unique • change

Temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context, with the objective of generating value.

PROGRAM

coordinated components • shared benefits

Related projects and activities managed in a coordinated way to obtain benefits not available individually.

PORTFOLIO

selection • balance • strategy

Projects, programs and operations managed as a group to achieve strategic objectives.

OPERATIONS

ongoing • repeatable • sustained

Ongoing, repeatable work that sustains a product or service after handover.

OUTPUT / DELIVERABLE

produced and accepted

Verifiable product, result or capability produced by the project and accepted against defined criteria.

OUTCOME

used and adopted

Change in behavior, capability or condition enabled when stakeholders use the output.

BENEFIT

measured and owned

Measurable improvement arising from an outcome; it needs an owner, a baseline, a target and a review date.

VALUE

weighed against cost and risk

Net worth of the benefits once cost, risk, timing, opportunity cost and strategic fit are considered.

STAKEHOLDER

affects or is affected

Individual or group that may affect, be affected by, or perceive itself affected by the project.

SPONSOR

authorizes • funds • owns benefits

Role that authorizes and funds the project, protects its direction and remains accountable for the benefits.

PROJECT MANAGER

integrates • leads • decides

Person assigned to lead the team, integrate the work and achieve the project objectives.

PMO

standardizes • enables • assures

Management structure that standardizes governance and facilitates sharing of methods, tools and resources.

NOTES — SLIDE 63

KEY DEFINITIONS RECAP

This page is the reference list for the whole lesson: twelve terms that carry the logic of Lesson 01. Do not memorize the wording; for each term write one example, one non-example and the decision the term supports.

Pay particular attention to the four-step chain output → outcome → benefit → value: in Italian these words are often translated with the same term, which hides the causal logic the lesson is built on. Keep the same care for project vs operations, program vs portfolio, and sponsor vs project manager.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which two terms do you still use as synonyms, and what rule separates them?

Recap & takeaways

Reconnect definitions, value, roles, governance and the PMO.

What should you remember—and apply?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 64

LESSON REVIEW

Use this section to consolidate the lesson into a connected mental model. Begin with classification: distinguish temporary project work from ongoing operations and recognize when coordination requires a program or portfolio perspective. Next, trace the value chain from accepted output through outcome and measurable benefit to value. Then connect governance to organizational structure, project-manager authority, PMO mandate, and PMO position.

A useful revision method is to apply the entire model to one initiative. State the intended change, define the project boundary, identify the operational transition, write one output, outcome, benefit, and value measure, and name who owns each important decision. Finally, decide what PMO support or control would improve performance without adding unnecessary process. If your explanation depends on unexplained labels, return to the relevant concept slide.

REVIEW QUESTION: Can you explain the lesson as one chain from strategic intent to sustainable operational value, naming the roles and evidence at each step?

What to remember and apply

THREE TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Projects are temporary and unique; operations sustain recurring work.**
- 2 Success connects outputs to outcomes, benefits, and strategic value—not only scope, time, and cost.**
- 3 Governance and decision rights should match the work, organizational level, and available evidence.**

TRANSFER TO PRACTICE

- Define the intended change before listing deliverables.
- Clarify roles, decision rights, and escalation paths.
- Name the benefit owner, evidence, and next decision.

ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

Temporary work creates value only when its output is adopted, changes an outcome, and produces a measurable benefit.

NOTES — SLIDE 65

THREE TAKEAWAYS

The first takeaway concerns classification: projects are temporary and unique, while operations sustain recurring value. The second concerns success: scope, time, and cost describe delivery performance, but value requires adoption, changed outcomes, measurable benefits, and strategic relevance. The third concerns governance: decision rights and controls must match the work, the organizational level, and the quality of available evidence.

These ideas reinforce one another. If the project boundary is unclear, transition to operations will be weak. If the value chain is unclear, teams may optimize activity or outputs that do not matter. If governance is unclear, important trade-offs may be delayed or made by people without the necessary mandate. Apply the transfer actions before detailed planning: define the intended change, clarify roles and escalation, and name the benefit owner and review point.

STUDY TIP: Turn each takeaway into a diagnostic question for project reviews.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which takeaway would prevent the greatest amount of rework in a project you know?

Projects sit inside a wider value system

01	PROJECT	Temporary work that creates a unique result and enables a specific change.
02	PROGRAM	Related projects and activities coordinated to realize benefits unavailable separately.
03	PORTFOLIO	Investments grouped to optimize strategy, balance, capacity, and risk.
04	OPERATIONS	Ongoing, repeatable work that sustains products, services, and organizational capability.

NOTES — SLIDE 66

THE WIDER VALUE SYSTEM

Projects exist within a wider system of programs, portfolios, and operations. A project creates a unique result and enables a specific change. A program coordinates related projects and activities to realize benefits that depend on integration. A portfolio selects and balances investments to achieve strategic objectives. Operations sustain products, services, and organizational capability after temporary change has been delivered.

These elements exchange information and responsibility. Portfolio decisions authorize or stop initiatives. Programs manage cross-project dependencies and benefits. Projects create outputs and transition capabilities. Operations adopt, use, support, and improve the results. Weak interfaces create common failures: projects may deliver outputs that operations cannot sustain, programs may optimize components without realizing benefits, and portfolios may continue work that no longer supports strategy.

STUDY TIP: Draw arrows for authorization, delivery, transition, performance data, and benefit feedback.

REVIEW QUESTION: What information should operations provide before a project is authorized, and what should the project provide at handover?

Plan your own work

Turn the lesson into a study plan and a capstone commitment.

How will you organize your study time?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 67

PLAN YOUR OWN WORK

This step turns the lesson into a commitment. Block three separate slots in your calendar rather than one long session: REVIEW, APPLY and TEST work far better when spaced across several days.

Decide now which initiative you will use for the whole self-study section — university, work or personal — and keep the same one from the value chain to the Vision Board. Changing case midway is the most common reason students end up with a board that nobody can assess.

STUDY TIP: Write the deadline and the three slots down before moving to the next page.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which initiative will you carry through the whole section, and why is it a good test case?

Key definitions for exam-ready recall

CORE TERMS

- 1 PROJECT**
Temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context, with the objective of generating value.
- 2 PROGRAM**
Related projects managed together to realize benefits unavailable separately.
- 3 PORTFOLIO**
Projects, programs, and other work grouped to achieve strategic objectives.

KEY DISTINCTIONS

- Project vs operations
- Output vs outcome
- Benefit vs value
- PMO mandate vs project authority

COMMON TRAP

Treating completed activity or an accepted deliverable as proof that value was created.

NOTES — SLIDE 68

EXAM-READY DEFINITIONS

For accurate recall, define each term by its management purpose. A project is a temporary endeavor that creates a unique product, service, or result. A program coordinates related components to obtain benefits unavailable from managing them separately. A portfolio groups work to achieve strategic objectives through prioritization and balance. Operations are ongoing and repeatable, sustaining products, services, and capability.

Definitions are only the starting point. Examinations and real decisions often test distinctions. An output is produced and accepted; an outcome is a change enabled through use; a benefit is a measurable improvement; value weighs benefits against cost, risk, timing, alternatives, and strategic fit. A PMO's mandate describes what it is authorized to do, while organizational position shapes its line of sight and practical influence.

STUDY TIP: Practice with paired comparisons and create one example and one non-example for each term.

REVIEW QUESTION: How would you explain the difference between a program and a portfolio without using the words “large” or “many”?

Final peer-review gate

PEER-REVIEW QUESTIONS

- 1** Is the initiative correctly framed as a project, program, portfolio, or operation?
- 2** Does the value chain connect output, outcome, benefit, and evidence?
- 3** Are assumptions, governance, decision ownership, and PMO responsibilities explicit?

EVIDENCE TO REQUEST

- Intended change and affected stakeholders
- Accepted output plus adoption or outcome evidence
- Benefit owner, assumptions, next action, and review date

QUALITY RULE

Accept the artifact only when it explains why the work exists, how value will be observed, and who owns the next decision.

NOTES — SLIDE 69

CAPSTONE PEER REVIEW

The peer-review gate tests whether an artifact supports responsible decisions. First, verify classification: is the work correctly framed as a project, program, portfolio, or operation, and is the boundary explicit? Second, test the value chain: does the output plausibly enable an outcome, is the benefit measurable, and is there evidence or a plan to collect it? Third, examine governance: are assumptions, decision owners, escalation paths, and PMO responsibilities clear?

Good peer review asks for evidence rather than personal preference. Request the intended change, affected stakeholders, acceptance criteria, adoption or outcome measures, benefit ownership, assumptions, review dates, and next action. A polished presentation should not pass if its causal logic or ownership is weak. Feedback should identify the decision at risk and propose a specific improvement.

STUDY TIP: Use “claim–evidence–owner–next review” as a four-part review pattern.

REVIEW QUESTION: What is the most important question to ask when an artifact lists many deliverables but no outcome evidence?

ASSESSED WORK: this feeds the Vision Board you will submit. It is marked on the 100-point assessment rubric — target and needs 25, product and value 35, vision statement 30, quality of the peer review you give 10. Read the rubric before you finalize it.

Check yourself

Answer in your own words, then mark your work against the model answers.

Can you explain it without the slides?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 70

SELF-CHECK STRATEGY

Self-testing is more effective when retrieval happens before rereading. Cover the slides and answer the questions from memory in complete sentences. Then compare your response with the lesson material, mark missing links or incorrect terms, and rewrite the answer more precisely. The goal is not to reproduce wording but to explain relationships and apply them.

Use three levels of practice. Retrieval asks for definitions and distinctions. Explanation asks why the distinction matters for decisions. Application asks you to classify a new situation, build a value chain, or identify an authority gap. Record confidence before checking the answer; high confidence with an incorrect answer identifies a priority for review. Return to the relevant slide and create a new example rather than simply rereading.

STUDY TIP: Space the self-check across several days and change the initiative used in each application.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which concept can you define correctly but still find difficult to apply, and what new example will you test?

Lesson 1: retrieve, explain, apply

Answer without notes first. Then revisit the relevant pages and improve each response.

RETRIEVAL QUESTIONS

1. What makes work a project, not an operation?
2. Why is the iron triangle incomplete?
3. How do outputs lead to outcomes, benefits, and value?
4. How does structure change PM authority?
5. How do mandate and position shape a PMO?

READ NEXT

- PMI: The Standard for Project Management
- ISO 21502:2020 overview
- PMI Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct

TRANSFER

Choose a current university, work, or personal project. Apply one tool from this lesson and explain the decision it supports.

NOTES — SLIDE 71

SELF-CHECK AND TRANSFER

Use retrieval before rereading. First answer each question from memory, then compare with the model answers on the next page and improve your explanation.

Projects differ from operations because projects are temporary and create unique change, while operations sustain repeatable value. The iron triangle is incomplete because scope, time and cost do not demonstrate quality, adoption, outcomes, benefits or stakeholder acceptance. Outputs lead to outcomes only when they are used; outcomes produce benefits that must be measured and owned; value weighs those benefits against cost, risk and alternatives. Structure changes the project manager's authority by moving resources and accountability towards or away from the project. A PMO is shaped by its mandate and by its position in the organization.

For transfer, choose a current initiative and apply one tool within 48 hours: a value chain, a project–operations boundary, a decision-readiness checklist or an explicit trade-off statement. Record what changed in your understanding or next action. Transfer is stronger evidence of learning than recognition alone.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which answer did you score below 2, and what example will you build to fix it?

Model answers — mark your own work

ANSWERS 1–3

- 1** Temporary work with a start and an end that creates a unique result; operations are ongoing and repeatable.
- 2** Scope, time and cost measure delivery only; they say nothing about adoption, outcome change, benefit or strategic fit.
- 3** An accepted output enables an outcome; the outcome produces a measurable benefit; value is that benefit weighed against cost, risk and alternatives.

ANSWERS 4–5

4. Authority grows as resources and accountability move towards the project: low in functional, shared in matrix, high in projectized.
5. The mandate states what the PMO may do (support, control, direct); its organizational position decides its line of sight and real influence.

SELF-MARKING

Score each answer 0–2: 0 missing, 1 partial, 2 complete with an example. Anything below 2 goes into your next review session.

NOTES — SLIDE 72

MODEL ANSWERS

Do not read this page before writing your own answers. Compare meaning, not wording: an answer is complete when it states the rule, gives one example and names the decision the concept supports.

Score each answer 0–2 and keep the list of items below 2 as your revision plan for the next session.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of the five concepts can you now explain to someone else without notes?

Knowledge check

Nine multiple-choice questions, then the answer key with the reasoning.

Where are the gaps you still need to close?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 73

KNOWLEDGE CHECK PREPARATION

The nine questions test connected foundations: the definition of a project, the distinction between projects and operations, evidence of value, organizational authority, and the PMO's role. Before choosing an answer, identify the concept being tested and eliminate options that confuse activity, output, authority, or documentation with the underlying management purpose.

Explain every choice. A project is temporary and creates a unique result; an operation sustains recurring work. Value is not proven by activity or acceptance alone but by outcome change linked to benefits. Project-manager authority tends to increase as resources and accountability move toward the project, while a PMO's role is shaped by mandate and organizational position. Distractors often sound plausible because they contain a true detail used in the wrong context.

STUDY TIP: After answering, explain why each incorrect option is wrong. This strengthens distinctions and reduces guessing.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which two concepts in the quiz are easiest to confuse, and what decision rule separates them?

Questions 1–3 of 9

Q1

Which statement best defines a project?

- A. Ongoing repetitive work
- B. Temporary work creating a unique result
- C. A group of unrelated tasks
- D. A permanent governance structure

Q2

Where does a PM usually have most authority?

- A. Functional organization
- B. Projectized organization
- C. Weak matrix organization
- D. Any structure—the authority is identical

Q3

Which evidence best demonstrates value?

- A. More activity completed
- B. An accepted output alone
- C. Outcome change linked to a benefit
- D. A detailed spending plan

Answer from memory first, then justify each choice in one sentence.

NOTES — SLIDE 74

KNOWLEDGE CHECK: QUESTIONS 1–3

Attempt every question before consulting the answer key. Identify the concept being tested, eliminate options that use a correct word in the wrong context, and justify the selected answer in one sentence.

Q1 tests the defining characteristics of a project: temporary work and a unique result. Q2 tests how organizational structure affects formal authority; authority is generally greatest when resources and accountability are organized around the project. Q3 tests evidence of value; completed activity or an accepted output alone does not prove an outcome or benefit.

STUDY TIP: For each rejected option, state the concept it actually describes.

REVIEW QUESTION: What rule separates evidence of delivery from evidence of value?

Questions 4–6 of 9

Q4

Which situation is an operation, not a project?

- A. Migrating the campus network to a new provider
- B. Running the weekly exam-booking service
- C. Merging two research centers
- D. Launching a new student portal

Q5

When is a program chosen instead of separate projects?

- A. When the budget is very large
- B. When benefits depend on coordinating related components
- C. When the work lasts more than one year
- D. When many departments are involved

Q6

Which PMO exercises the highest authority?

- A. Supportive PMO
- B. Controlling PMO
- C. Directive PMO
- D. Agile Center of Excellence

Answer from memory first, then justify each choice in one sentence.

NOTES — SLIDE 75

KNOWLEDGE CHECK: QUESTIONS 4–6

Q4 tests the project/operations boundary: recurring work that sustains an existing service is an operation, even when it is demanding. Q5 tests why a program exists: coordination is justified by interdependent benefits, not by budget, duration or number of departments. Q6 tests the PMO authority spectrum: supportive advises, controlling assures, directive owns delivery.

STUDY TIP: For every rejected option, state the concept it actually describes.

REVIEW QUESTION: For each rejected option, which concept does it actually describe?

Questions 7–9 of 9

Q7

What shows that transition to operations is complete?

- A. The deliverable has been formally accepted
- B. The project budget has been closed
- C. Operations sustain the result without the project team
- D. The final report has been archived

Q8

In a weak matrix, who usually wins a priority conflict?

- A. The project manager
- B. The functional manager
- C. The enterprise PMO
- D. The team member

Q9

Which Vision Board field is revised first?

- A. Business value
- B. Product
- C. Target group
- D. Barriers

Answer from memory first, then justify each choice in one sentence. Record your confidence before checking the key.

NOTES — SLIDE 76

KNOWLEDGE CHECK: QUESTIONS 7–9

Q7 tests transition readiness: acceptance closes delivery, but the change is sustainable only when operations can run it without the temporary team. Q8 tests organizational authority: in a weak matrix the functional manager keeps control of resources and priorities. Q9 tests the logic of the Vision Board: if needs diverge substantially, the segmentation itself is wrong, so the target group must be restructured before features or value.

STUDY TIP: Re-answer after two days and explain the reasoning without using the option letters.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of these three distinctions would change a real decision in a project you know?

Answer key • Questions 1–9

- Q1** **B** A project is a temporary endeavor undertaken in a unique context to generate value.
- Q2** **B** In a projectized structure, the project manager typically has the greatest formal authority.
- Q3** **C** Value requires an observable outcome change linked to an intended benefit.
- Q4** **B** Running the weekly exam-booking service is recurring work that sustains an existing service: an operation.
- Q5** **B** A program exists when benefits depend on coordinating related components—not because of budget or duration.
- Q6** **C** A directive PMO owns delivery accountability and may assign project managers; supportive advises, controlling assures.
- Q7** **C** Acceptance closes delivery; transition is complete when operations sustain the result without the project team.
- Q8** **B** In a weak matrix the functional manager keeps control of resources and priorities.
- Q9** **C** If two groups have very different needs, restructure the target group before revising features or value.
- TRANSFER** Which current initiative could you classify, map to value, and govern with clearer authority and PMO support?

NOTES — SLIDE 77

CONSOLIDATED ANSWER KEY FOR FULL 9 QUESTION QUIZ.

Walk the answers in order, but spend the time on the reasoning, not the letters: Q1-Q3 test the definition of a project, formal authority by structure, and the outcome-to-benefit link; Q4-Q6 separate projects from operations, programs from large projects, and the three PMO archetypes; Q7-Q9 cover closure versus transition, the weak matrix, and target-group segmentation. Close with the transfer question so students apply the lesson to a live initiative of their own.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which answer surprised you, and which page do you need to revisit?

Apply it

Take your own initiative through the applied lab and product positioning.

Does your Vision Board survive the rubric?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 78

APPLY IT

This is the productive core of the self-study section: everything before it prepares the vocabulary, everything after it checks the result. Allow the full 40 minutes and work on paper or on a whiteboard first — the format forces prioritization.

Produce two artifacts: a Product Vision Box for your initiative and a one-sentence positioning statement. Then open the assessment rubric and score your own board criterion by criterion before considering it finished.

STUDY TIP: Draft fast, then delete. A board improves more by removing unjustified features than by adding new ones.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which feature on your board cannot be traced back to a stated need?

Before you score yourself against the rubric: can you do all of this?

THREE THINGS YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO

- 1 1 • EXPLAIN THE VOCABULARY**
I can define project, program, portfolio and operations, and place a real initiative in the right category with one reason.
- 2 2 • CONNECT OUTPUTS TO VALUE**
I can take one deliverable and state its outcome, its benefit with an indicator and an owner, and the value it creates.
- 3 3 • POSITION THE ROLES**
I can say what a sponsor, a project manager and a PMO each decide, and which PMO mandate fits a given organization.

IF YOU ANSWER “NOT YET”

- Vocabulary → go back to the key definitions recap
- Outputs to value → redo the core framework and the value page
- Roles and PMO → review the role and PMO pages in the lesson
- Then retake the knowledge check and compare with the answer key

READY WHEN

You can answer all three out loud, with one example from your own Vision Board, without looking at the slides.

NOTES — SLIDE 79

SELF-ASSESSMENT BEFORE THE RUBRIC

Use this page as a gate, not as a summary. Answer the three statements out loud, without the slides, using your own Vision Board as the example. If any answer needs a slide, you are not ready for the rubric yet.

The three abilities map onto the three blocks of the lesson: vocabulary and classification, the output → outcome → benefit → value chain, and the roles that own each decision. The remediation list tells you exactly which page to revisit for each gap, so treat a "not yet" as a route, not as a verdict.

Remember that the assessment rubric presented in class (end of Part 01) carries 100 points, of which 10 are for the quality of the peer review you give to another team — so prepare that review as carefully as your own board.

REVIEW QUESTION: Which of the three abilities is still a "not yet", and which page will you redo first?

Go deeper

Optional extension: what project success really means, and the professional standard behind it.

Which of these applies to your organization?

RECAP

PLAN

SELF-CHECK

QUIZ

APPLY

GO DEEPER

NOTES — SLIDE 80

GO DEEPER: HOW TO USE THIS OPTIONAL BLOCK

This final step is optional. It extends the lesson in two directions: what project success really means beyond delivery performance, and how the professional standard — the PMBOK® Guide, 8th edition — is now structured.

Read it selectively rather than sequentially.

Success is verified at three levels: outputs, outcomes, benefits

Each level needs its own evidence and its own owner.

01 OUTPUTS

Deliverables produced

WHAT TO VERIFY

Deliverables accepted
Required quality demonstrated
Scope goals achieved

WHY “ON TIME AND ON BUDGET” MISLEADS

Scope, time and budget measure the plan, not the purpose: a team can meet all three and still hand over a result nobody uses.

02 OUTCOMES

Changes in behavior

WHAT TO VERIFY

New ways of working adopted
Performance indicators move
The change is sustained

THE REVERSE CASE

A project that leaves its baseline for an agreed, evidence-based reason can be more successful than one that never moved.

03 BENEFITS

Value realized in context

WHAT TO VERIFY

Benefits are used
Benefits support strategy
An owner tracks them

Delivery ends at acceptance — the innovation festival can open on time and still fail if students do not attend or partners do not return.

NOTES — SLIDE 81

RESULTS AND VALUE

Project results and value are related but verified at different moments. Results concern accepted outputs and whether defined goals, deliverables, and quality criteria were achieved. Value concerns whether those outputs are used, produce useful benefits, support strategy, and can be sustained in the real context. Acceptance can close delivery, while benefit realization may continue for months or years.

This distinction prevents a common error: declaring success solely because a deliverable was completed. A new scheduling system may meet technical requirements yet create little value if users avoid it or if operations cannot support it. Value also requires comparison with cost, risk, timing, and alternative uses of resources. Therefore, the project team should define both delivery measures and post-handover outcome measures, with named owners and review dates.

EXAMPLE: “System accepted” is a result; “waiting time reduced by 20% while service quality is maintained” is benefit evidence.

REVIEW QUESTION: Who should own value measurement after project closure, and why?

THE “ON TIME AND ON BUDGET” TRAP. Scope, time and cost measure how well the plan was executed. A team can hit all three and still hand over something nobody uses: delivery discipline protects the plan, not the purpose, so a clean baseline says nothing about adoption, outcomes or benefits.

THE REVERSE CASE is equally important and less intuitive: a project that deviates from its baseline for a good reason — because evidence changed the intended outcome — can be more successful than one that never moved. Judge the change by whether the decision was explicit, authorized and evidence-based.

EXAMPLE: the university innovation festival can open on the announced date, within budget, and still fail if students do not attend and partners do not renew the relationship. The date is an output measure; attendance and continued partnerships are outcome and benefit measures.

STUDY PROMPT: write your own definition of project success in one sentence, then test it against a project that was delivered on plan and still disappointed.

REVIEW QUESTION: which baseline deviation in a project you know actually improved the outcome, and who authorized it?

01

STUDY EXTENSION • PROFESSIONAL STANDARD

PMBOK® Guide, 8th Edition

What changed in 2025 — and how the new architecture fits together.

Which structure do seven domains and five focus areas give your project?



STUDY EXTENSION • PMI, PMBOK® Guide, 8th ed. (2025)

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 82

WHY THE EIGHTH EDITION MATTERS FOR THIS COURSE

This short section places the vocabulary used all through Lesson 01 inside the current PMI architecture. Every definition in this course — project, value, performance domain, governance — follows the PMBOK® Guide, Eighth Edition, released in November 2025, and the Lexicon v5.0.

Two pages follow: what changed from the Seventh Edition, and a map of the seven performance domains against the five focus areas. Neither is required for the knowledge check; both are useful if you intend to certify or to work in an organization that has adopted the standard.

Six principles, seven domains, five focus areas

Released 13 November 2025, the Eighth Edition blends the principles of the 7th with the process structure practitioners missed — in one unified book.

SIX PRINCIPLES

12 → 6

The 12 principles of the 7th edition are consolidated into six sharper statements of behavior.

WHAT CHANGED

Stewardship, value, systems thinking and leadership survive in a tighter set that still describes how to think, not what to do.

WHY IT MATTERS

The “why” stays principle-based.

SEVEN DOMAINS

8 → 7

Governance, Scope, Schedule, Finance, Stakeholders, Resources, Risk.

WHAT CHANGED

Governance replaces Integration and Finance replaces Cost; Quality and Communications are embedded in the domains and Procurement moves to an appendix.

WHY IT MATTERS

Each domain now carries its own processes.

FIVE FOCUS AREAS

49 → 40 PROCESSES

Process groups return as Focus Areas: Initiating, Planning, Executing, Monitoring & Controlling, Closing.

WHAT CHANGED

40 non-prescriptive, tailorable processes are mapped across the seven domains, with expanded guidance on AI, PMOs and procurement.

WHY IT MATTERS

Structure is back, without a rigid checklist.

Sources: PMI — PMBOK® Guide, Eighth Edition (2025); PMI Lexicon v5.0

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

NOTES — SLIDE 83

PMBOK® GUIDE, EIGHTH EDITION

The Eighth Edition was released on 13 November 2025 and is the most data-driven update in the guide's history, built on more than 48,000 practitioner data points. It reconciles two earlier positions: the process detail of the Sixth Edition and the principle-based flexibility of the Seventh.

Three structural changes matter. First, the twelve principles become six. Second, the eight performance domains become seven — Governance (closest to the former Integration), Scope, Schedule, Finance (closest to the former Cost), Stakeholders, Resources and Risk; Quality and Communications are no longer standalone but embedded where they are operationally relevant, and Procurement is treated in an appendix. Third, processes return: 40 non-prescriptive processes are embedded in the domains and mapped to five Focus Areas — the familiar Initiating, Planning, Executing, Monitoring & Controlling and Closing.

The edition also expands coverage of artificial intelligence, of PMOs and of procurement, and reunifies the standard and the guide into a single publication.

Where each performance domain does its work

The seven domains run in parallel; the five focus areas say when their 40 processes are typically applied.

PERFORMANCE DOMAIN	INITIATING	PLANNING	EXECUTING	MONITORING & CONTROLLING	CLOSING
GOVERNANCE	Charter and authorize	Set decision rights and controls	Direct and integrate the work	Assure, report, escalate	Close and confirm value
SCOPE	Identify needs	Define scope and requirements	Deliver the scope	Validate and control changes	Confirm acceptance
SCHEDULE	Outline the timeline	Sequence, estimate, baseline	Progress the work	Control schedule performance	Close the baseline
FINANCE	Frame the business case	Estimate, budget, fund	Commit and spend	Control cost and benefits	Final account
STAKEHOLDERS	Identify stakeholders	Plan engagement	Engage and communicate	Monitor engagement	Hand over and transition
RESOURCES	Outline capacity needs	Plan teams and procurement	Acquire and develop teams	Manage performance	Release resources
RISK	Surface initial risks	Plan responses	Implement responses	Monitor risks and issues	Capture lessons

Governance is the largest domain (9 of the 40 processes) and spans all five focus areas; Planning carries the most processes overall.

NOTES — SLIDE 84

FOCUS AREAS × PERFORMANCE DOMAINS

In the Eighth Edition the seven performance domains are continuous areas of practice: they run in parallel for the whole life of the project, never in sequence. The five focus areas — Initiating, Planning, Executing, Monitoring & Controlling, Closing — are the returning process groups, and they indicate when a process of a domain is typically applied, not a mandatory order.

Read the table by row to understand a domain end to end, and by column to prepare a stage of the project. Governance is the overarching domain: all the others operate inside the decision rights, standards and escalation paths it defines.

The cells describe the intent of the work, not a fixed process list: the 40 processes are explicitly non-prescriptive and must be tailored to approach, risk and complexity, whether predictive, agile or hybrid.

Further reading (optional) and bridge to Lesson 02

OPTIONAL — FOR DEEPER STUDY

- 1** **PMBOK® GUIDE, 8th ed.**
Six principles, seven performance domains and five focus areas — mapped in the study extension pages of this deck.
- 2** **ISO 21502:2020**
Clauses on context and on integrated project-management practices: governance, direction and benefit realization.

MOODLE

Slides, the Vision Board template and the answer keys are available on Moodle — self-enrolment key: **PM2026**.

BRIDGE TO LESSON 02 • 07 OCT

- Topic: Waterfall, Agile and Hybrid approaches

NOTES — SLIDE 85

READINGS AND BRIDGE

The bridge to Lesson 02 matters: the life cycle you will choose next week depends on the uncertainty in the initiative you modeled this week, so bring that value chain with you.